GnssProcessor: Mathematical Reference

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1 Introduction

This document is the mathematical companion to `GnssProcessor`, a C++17 post-processing and real-time GNSS engine implementing PPP, PPP-RTK, and double-differenced baseline modes. Its scope is the estimation mathematics and design rationale, in roughly the order the engine applies them:

- State vector layout (Section 3) — which states the filter carries and when each is enabled.
- Observation equations (Section 4) — the *uncombined* pseudorange and carrier-phase models the filter linearizes around.
- Differencing transformations (Section 5) — the between-satellite single-difference (BSSD) used in PPP-RTK and the double-difference (DD) used in baseline modes, including the S-transform structure that maps undifferenced parameters to differenced ones.
- The estimation engine (Section 6) — the variable-dimension Kalman filter (Joseph-form update, prior-anchored iterated relinearisation, robust gating) and the backward RTS smoother.

- Cycle-slip detection and repair (Section 7) — the linear-combination test statistics (Melbourne–Wübbena, geometry-free, GRAPHIC, extra-wide-lane) and the TurboEdit 2×2 integer repair.
- Integer ambiguity resolution (Section 8) — the MLAMBDA integer least-squares search, wide-lane / narrow-lane decomposition, validation, and constrained feedback.
- Inertial aiding (Section 9) — the strapdown mechanisation and 15-state INS error model of the tightly-coupled IMU path.
- Real-time SSR corrections (Section 10) — how State Space Representation orbit, clock, and bias corrections refine the undifferenced observation model.

Implementation details (function signatures, class responsibilities, config field reference) live in the headers under `include/` and are rendered via Doxygen. When this document references a specific algorithmic component, it cites the source file directly (e.g. `src/core/filter/KalmanFilter.cpp`).

The notation follows the IGS conventions adopted by Subirana, Zornoza, and Hernández-Pajares [10] and Teunissen and Montenbruck [13]; see Section 2 for the symbol table this document depends on.

2 Notation and conventions

Indices and sets. We use lower-case Latin letters for indices and calligraphic upper-case for sets:

- $r \in \mathcal{R}$ — receiver. Single-receiver modes (PPP, PPP-RTK) have $|\mathcal{R}| = 1$; baseline modes have a fixed reference and one or more rovers.
- $g \in \mathcal{G} = \{\text{GPS}, \text{GAL}, \text{BDS}, \text{GLO}, \text{QZS}, \dots\}$ — constellation.
- $i \in \mathcal{S}_g$ — satellite of constellation g. p_g denotes the pivot satellite of constellation g under the BSSD parameterisation (Section 5).
- $s \in \mathcal{B}$ — signal/observation type, identified by its RINEX-3 three-character code (e.g. `C1C`, `L2W`, `L5X`).
- $k \in \mathbb{N}$ — discrete epoch index.

Vectors and matrices. Bold lower-case for vectors ($\boldsymbol{x}$, $\boldsymbol{r}$); bold upper-case for matrices ($\boldsymbol{H}$, $\boldsymbol{P}$). $\boldsymbol{a}^{\mathrm{T}}$ is the transpose. A hat denotes a state estimate; a tilde a one-step prediction: $\hat{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k|k}$ vs. $\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k|k-1}$.

Observables. For each receiver/satellite/signal triple, the engine consumes two real-valued observables (in metres) per epoch:

- $P^i_{r,s}$ — pseudorange (code), in metres.
- $\Phi^i_{r,s}$ — carrier phase, scaled to metres via λ_s. The accumulated cycle count $\Phi^i_{r,s} \cdot \lambda_s^{-1}$ is the integer ambiguity plus a fractional bias.

Where the distinction matters, s may further denote the band ($L_1, L_2, L_5, \dots$) and the tracking attribute (e.g. `C`, `W`, `X`).

Frequencies and wavelengths. f_s is the carrier frequency (Hz) and $\lambda_s = c/f_s$ the wavelength (m). The frequency-squared scaling factor used to project the L1-equivalent slant ionospheric delay onto signal s is

$$\mu_s \;:=\; \frac{f_1^2}{f_s^2}. \tag{1}$$

Differencing operators. Three differencing operations recur throughout the document:

$$\Delta q^{i,p_g}_{r,s} := q^i_{r,s} - q^{p_g}_{r,s}, \quad \nabla q^i_{r_1 r_2,s} := q^i_{r_1,s} - q^i_{r_2,s}, \quad \nabla\Delta q^{i,p_g}_{r_1 r_2,s} := \Delta\big(\nabla q^i_{r_1 r_2,s}\big).$$

Read Δq as "between-satellite single difference of q relative to pivot p_g," ∇q as "between-receiver single difference," and $\nabla\Delta q$ as "double difference."

Sign conventions. We adopt the convention that the slant ionospheric delay $I^i_{r,s}$ enters *additively* on the code observable and *subtractively* on the carrier phase observable; this is the source of the well-known "code–phase divergence." All other range-additive terms (geometry, clocks, troposphere, biases) carry the same sign on both observables. See Equations (4) and (5) for the explicit equations.

Symbol table.

Symbol	Units	Meaning
$\boldsymbol{r}_r, \boldsymbol{r}^i$	m	ECEF position of receiver/satellite
ρ^i_r	m	geometric range $\|\boldsymbol{r}^i - \boldsymbol{r}_r\|$
$\boldsymbol{e}^i_r$	—	unit LOS from r to i in ECEF
$c\,\mathrm{d}t_r$	m	receiver clock offset (scaled by c)
$c\,\mathrm{d}t^i$	m	satellite clock offset (from CLK product)
$c\,\delta t^{(g)}_r$	m	receiver inter-system time offset for constellation $g \neq g_{\mathrm{ref}}$
T^i_r	m	total tropospheric path delay
$\mathrm{ZHD}^i_r, \mathrm{ZWD}^i_r$	m	zenith hydrostatic / wet components
$I^i_{r,1}$	m	L1-equivalent slant ionospheric delay
$N^i_{r,s}$	cyc	integer carrier-phase ambiguity
$b_{r,s}, b^i_s$	m	receiver / satellite phase biases
$B_{r,s}, B^i_s$	m	receiver / satellite code biases (OSB)
$\varepsilon^P, \varepsilon^\Phi$	m	residual (multipath + thermal)
$\boldsymbol{v}_r$	m/s	receiver velocity (optional / IMU state)
$\lambda_{\mathrm{WL}},\ \lambda_{\mathrm{NL}}$	m	wide- / narrow-lane wavelength $c/(f_1 \mp f_2)$
$\boldsymbol{C}^e_b$	—	body-to-ECEF attitude (direction-cosine) matrix

3 State vector layout

The Kalman filter operates on a state vector $\boldsymbol{x}_k \in \mathbb{R}^{n_k}$ whose dimension n_k *varies across epochs*: per-satellite and per-(satellite, signal) substates are added when a new sat/signal is first observed and pruned (or marked stale) when the satellite drops below the elevation mask or its phase track is interrupted by a cycle slip without recovery. All bookkeeping — key→index maps, free-list re-use, and dimensional reshaping of $\boldsymbol{x}$ and $\boldsymbol{P}$ — is encapsulated in `StateManager`; `KalmanFilter` consumes the state through that interface and never indexes raw memory by hard-coded offsets.

3.1 Schematic layout

In schematic form, suppressing the epoch index k:

$$\begin{aligned}\boldsymbol{x} \;=\; [\; & \underbrace{\boldsymbol{r}_r^{\mathrm{T}}}_{3},\; \underbrace{\boldsymbol{v}_r^{\mathrm{T}}}_{0\text{ or }3},\; \underbrace{c\,\mathrm{d}t_r}_{1},\; \underbrace{(c\,\delta t_r^{(g)})_{g\neq g_{\mathrm{ref}}}^{\mathrm{T}}}_{|\mathcal{G}|-1},\\ & \underbrace{\mathrm{ZWD}_r,\,(g_N, g_E)}_{1+0\text{ or }1+2},\; \underbrace{(c\,\mathrm{d}t_r^{\phi})}_{0\text{ or }1},\\ & \underbrace{(I_{r,1}^i)_{i\in\mathcal{V}_k}^{\mathrm{T}}}_{|\mathcal{V}_k|},\; \underbrace{(N_{r,s}^i)_{(i,s)\in\mathcal{A}_k}^{\mathrm{T}}}_{|\mathcal{A}_k|},\\ & \underbrace{(B_{r,s})_{s\in\mathcal{B}}^{\mathrm{T}}}_{|\mathcal{B}|},\; \underbrace{(B_s^i)_{(i,s)\in\mathcal{D}_k}^{\mathrm{T}}}_{|\mathcal{D}_k|}\;]^{\mathrm{T}}. \end{aligned} \tag{2}$$

where

- $\mathcal{V}_k$ is the set of satellites currently visible at epoch k (i.e. above the elevation mask, with valid orbit/clock products and at least one tracked signal),
- $\mathcal{A}_k \subseteq \mathcal{V}_k \times \mathcal{B}$ is the set of phase-tracked (satellite, signal) pairs,
- $\mathcal{D}_k \subseteq \mathcal{V}_k \times \mathcal{B}$ is the subset of (satellite, signal) pairs for which the BIA product lacks a satellite OSB and a state-space estimate is therefore created (see `estimation.estimate_sat_biases`).

For brevity the schematic suppresses three conditional refinements detailed below: the rate states that accompany velocity (a receiver clock-rate and one inter-system clock-rate offset per non-reference constellation), the nine-state inertial augmentation of Section 9, and the fact that the entire receiver-side clock and inter-system-offset block is removed under the BSSD parameterisation (Section 5.1).

3.2 Component-by-component description

Position $\boldsymbol{r}_r \in \mathbb{R}^3$. ECEF Cartesian receiver position. Always present. Initialised either from the RINEX header approximate position or, after the first epoch, from a Weighted Least-Squares (WLS) seed solution to within the linearisation radius of the geometric range model (Section 4.3).

Velocity $\boldsymbol{v}_r \in \mathbb{R}^3$. Optional. Enabled by `estimation.estimate_velocity = true`, or forced on by tightly-coupled IMU integration. When present, position and velocity form a coupled continuous-white-noise-acceleration (CWNA, integrated-random-walk) block driven by a *single* acceleration spectral density `process_noise.acceleration_psd` (Equation (20)); the scalar `position_q` of the velocity-free case is then unused. Enabling velocity also introduces a receiver clock-rate state $c\,\dot{\mathrm{d}}t_r$, and one inter-system clock-rate offset per non-reference constellation, each CWNA-coupled to its bias counterpart (`clock_rate_q`, `system_time_rate_offset_q`).

Receiver clock $c\,\mathrm{d}t_r$. Single state, in metres. Process noise is large (`clock_bias_q` $\sim 10^3\,\mathrm{m}^2$ per second) so the state is effectively re-estimated each epoch; this captures oscillator drift without imposing a stochastic model that may not match the receiver's actual oscillator. Under the BSSD (between-satellite single-difference) parameterisation (Section 5.1) the receiver clock is unobservable and the state is dropped entirely — as are the inter-system offsets below — so the whole receiver-side clock block vanishes in PPP-RTK SD mode.

Inter-system time offsets $c\,\delta t_r^{(g)}$. One per active constellation other than the chosen reference (default GPS). These absorb the per-constellation clock biases that arise from mixing analysis-centre-defined clock products across systems ("GAL − GPS time offset," etc.).

Tropospheric ZWD and gradients. ZWD_r models the zenith wet delay; the zenith hydrostatic component ZHD_r is treated deterministically via the Saastamoinen model [9]. Total slant tropospheric delay is then

$$T_r^i \;=\; m_h(\theta_r^i)\,\mathrm{ZHD}_r \;+\; m_w(\theta_r^i)\,\mathrm{ZWD}_r \;+\; m_w(\theta_r^i)\cot\theta_r^i\big[g_N\cos\alpha_r^i + g_E\sin\alpha_r^i\big], \tag{3}$$

with elevation θ_r^i, azimuth α_r^i, and the Niell or VMF mapping functions m_h, m_w. Gradients (g_N, g_E) are optional.

Per-satellite slant ionosphere $I_{r,1}^i$. PPP-RTK-only. One state per visible satellite, expressed at the L1 frequency; signal-specific delays follow Equation (1). Initial value seeded from the Klobuchar broadcast model when no external ionospheric product is available. Its process noise is a random walk whose zenith spectral density `ionosphere_q` is projected onto the slant by the squared obliquity factor $1/\sin^2\theta_r^i$ (Equation (19)), letting low-elevation states vary faster. Modelling these per-sat states explicitly is what permits PPP-RTK to retain integer ambiguity recovery without forming the ionosphere-free combination (which amplifies code noise by a factor of ~ 3).

Carrier-phase ambiguities $N_{r,s}^i$. One state per phase-tracked (i, s) pair, in cycles. Treated as float during the prediction/update cycle and resolved to integers post-hoc by the LAMBDA-family algorithms in `filter/AmbiguityResolver` [12] when AR is enabled. Cycle slips trigger a re-seed via `StateManager::resetAmbiguity`, which inflates the diagonal covariance entry while preserving the cross-state correlations that permit a consistent re-fix.

Receiver code biases $B_{r,s}$. These absorb the receiver-side inter-frequency biases that the OSB convention does not reference to zero. They are *not* one per signal: `StateInitializer::resolveReceiverBias` keys them per (system, frequency band) as inter-frequency biases (`"<system>_IFB<band>"`) plus, in the alternative scheme, a single per-system differential code bias (`"<system>_DCB"`). Like the receiver clock they are suppressed under BSSD.

Satellite code biases B_s^i. Per (satellite, signal) pair, but *only when the BIA file does not supply an OSB* for that pair — typically a third-frequency signal in a triple-frequency setup. When present, these states are weakly stochastic (`sat_bias_q` $\sim 10^{-10}$) since the underlying physical biases are nearly stationary on the daily timescale.

Inertial augmentation. When a tightly-coupled IMU is active the core state grows by nine further entries — a three-axis attitude error and the accelerometer and gyroscope biases — propagated by the strapdown mechanisation rather than the random-walk process model. These are treated in full in Section 9.

Baseline differential troposphere. In baseline mode the per-station tropospheric, clock, ionosphere, and bias states are absent; an optional single differential zenith-wet-delay state $\Delta\mathrm{ZWD}_{r_{\mathrm{rov}}r_{\mathrm{ref}}}$ may be carried (`baseline.estimate_differential_tropo`, Section 5.3).

3.3 Dynamic indexing

The variable-dimension blocks are addressed via key→index maps maintained by `StateManager`. The canonical key formats are defined once in `include/filter/StateKeySchema.hpp`, each with a `make`/`parse` pair:

- iono key: `"<sys><prn>"`, e.g. `"G05"` (delimiter-free);
- ambiguity key: `"<sys><prn>_<signal>"`, e.g. `"G05_L1C"` — split on the *first* underscore, so an iono-free combination `"G05_L1C_L5Q"` retains its compound signal;
- satellite signal-bias key: `"<sys><prn>|<signal>"`, e.g. `"G05|C1W"` — a *pipe* delimiter and a distinct map, *not* the underscore ambiguity namespace;
- receiver code-bias key: `"<system>_IFB<band>"` or `"<system>_DCB"`;
- inter-system time-offset key: the bare system name (`"Galileo"`, ...; GPS is the reference and never appears);
- double-difference ambiguity key (baseline): `"DD|<cons>|<sat>|<code>|<pivot>"`.

This single source of truth eliminates the off-by-one errors that plague hand-managed dynamic state vectors and makes the BSSD/DD S-transforms (Section 5) implementable as block operations on the relevant key sets.

Ambiguity basis. By default the ambiguity block carries one per-band float ambiguity per tracked (satellite, signal) in metres. Setting `estimation.state_ambiguity_basis = "nl_wl"` switches the whole run to a narrow-lane / wide-lane parameterisation: per satellite a narrow-lane state (key `"<sat>_NL_<band>"`) and one wide-lane state per band pair (`"<sat>_WL_<a>_<b>"`, semantically $N_a - N_b$), both in *cycles* rather than metres so the wide-lane and LAMBDA arithmetic stays native to integers, with the wavelength scaling moved into the Jacobian. The two bases never coexist in a single state vector.

4 Observation equations

This section gives the full *undifferenced* observation model that the filter linearises around at each epoch. The PPP-RTK parameterisation is uncombined: per-signal pseudorange and carrier phase are consumed directly, without forming ionosphere-free or wide-lane combinations as a preprocessing step. Combinations (IF, MW, GF) are still computed for diagnostic and slip-detection purposes (Section 7; see `slip/MwSlipDetector`, `slip/GraphicSlipDetector`) but they do not enter the measurement update path.

4.1 Code (pseudorange) observation

For receiver r tracking satellite i on signal s, the observed pseudorange is

$$\boxed{P^i_{r,s} \;=\; \rho^i_r \;+\; c(\mathrm{d}t_r - \mathrm{d}t^i) \;+\; c\,\delta t_r^{(g(i))} \;+\; T^i_r \;+\; \mu_s\, I^i_{r,1} \;+\; B_{r,s} - B^i_s \;+\; \varepsilon^P_{r,i,s}.} \tag{4}$$

4.2 Carrier-phase observation

The corresponding carrier-phase observation, scaled to metres by λ_s, is

$$\boxed{\Phi^i_{r,s} \;=\; \rho^i_r \;+\; c(\mathrm{d}t_r - \mathrm{d}t^i) \;+\; c\,\delta t_r^{(g(i))} \;+\; T^i_r \;-\; \mu_s\, I^i_{r,1} \;+\; \lambda_s\, N^i_{r,s} \;+\; b_{r,s} - b^i_s \;+\; \varepsilon^\Phi_{r,i,s}.} \tag{5}$$

The defining structural difference between Equations (4) and (5) is the sign of the ionospheric term: $+\mu_s I$ on code, $-\mu_s I$ on phase. Three additional remarks:

1. The phase ambiguity $N^i_{r,s}$ is integer in principle but is contaminated by the receiver-plus-satellite phase biases $b_{r,s} - b^i_s$. In a *float* solution these biases are absorbed into $N^i_{r,s}$, leaving a non-integer state with no structural advantage over the code observation. Recovering integer-valued ambiguities therefore requires either external Fractional Cycle Bias (FCB) products or differencing (Section 5), which cancels common-mode bias terms.
2. The clock product $c\,\mathrm{d}t^i$ is read from the analysis-centre CLK file (post-processing) or refined from the broadcast clock by a streamed SSR correction (real-time, Section 10) and treated as deterministic in the filter; any residual product error appears on the observation and is absorbed by the receiver clock state.
3. The system time offset $c\,\delta t_r^{(g(i))}$ is zero by construction when $g(i)$ is the reference constellation (default GPS). Together with the receiver clock $c\,\mathrm{d}t_r$ this means a multi-constellation run carries $|\mathcal{G}|$ clock-like states in total.

4.3 Geometric range and linearisation

The geometric range $\rho^i_r = \|\boldsymbol{r}^i - \boldsymbol{r}_r\|_2$ enters Equations (4) and (5) non-linearly through the receiver position $\boldsymbol{r}_r$. The filter linearises about the current state estimate $\hat{\boldsymbol{r}}_r$:

$$\rho^i_r \;=\; \hat{\rho}^i_r \;-\; (\boldsymbol{e}^i_{\hat{r}})^{\mathrm{T}}(\boldsymbol{r}_r - \hat{\boldsymbol{r}}_r) \;+\; \mathcal{O}\big(\|\boldsymbol{r}_r - \hat{\boldsymbol{r}}_r\|^2\big)\,, \tag{6}$$

with the unit line-of-sight

$$\boldsymbol{e}^i_{\hat{r}} \;:=\; \frac{\boldsymbol{r}^i - \hat{\boldsymbol{r}}_r}{\|\boldsymbol{r}^i - \hat{\boldsymbol{r}}_r\|_2}. \tag{7}$$

The Jacobian row $\boldsymbol{H}_{(i,s)}$ contributing to the design matrix at the position columns is therefore $-(\boldsymbol{e}^i_{\hat{r}})^{\mathrm{T}}$. For sub-metre residual targets this single linearisation per epoch is sufficient; the engine optionally relinearises within the epoch (`processing.relinearize_geometry`, on by default) to handle long initial position offsets.

The satellite position $\boldsymbol{r}^i$ is itself a function of the transmission time, which depends on ρ^i_r/c and therefore on $\boldsymbol{r}_r$. Resolving this implicit dependency by fixed-point iteration (typically 1–2 sweeps) is performed by `model/ModelGeometry`.

4.4 Stochastic model

Observation noise covariance is structured per epoch as a block diagonal matrix with entries

$$\sigma^2_{r,i,s} \;=\; \sigma^2_{0,\mathrm{type}(s)} \;\cdot\; w(\theta^i_r)^{-1} \;\cdot\; \xi(\mathrm{C/N_0 \text{ at } } (r,i,s)), \tag{8}$$

combining a per-type baseline ($\sigma_{0,\mathrm{code}}$, $\sigma_{0,\mathrm{phase}}$ from `filter.measurement_noise`), an elevation-dependent down-weighting factor $w(\theta) \in \{1, \sin\theta, \sin^2\theta, \dots\}$ selected by `filter.stochastic_model`, and an optional carrier-to-noise ratio scaling ξ parameterised by `snr_model_params`. Cross-correlations between observations are assumed zero in the undifferenced parameterisation; differencing introduces structured correlations handled in Section 5.

5 Differencing transformations

PPP-RTK and baseline modes do not consume the undifferenced observations of Equations (4) and (5) directly. Each forms a linear combination across satellites (BSSD), receivers (BRSD), or both (DD), absorbing common-mode terms into the cancellation and recovering integer-friendly residual structure. This section gives both the algebraic cancellations and the matrix-form S-transforms that map undifferenced parameters to differenced ones.

5.1 Between-satellite single difference (BSSD)

For each constellation g, choose a pivot satellite p_g (typically the highest-elevation tracked sat with a stable phase lock; see `filter/PivotManager`, "sticky pivot" policy). For any non-pivot satellite $i \in \mathcal{S}_g \setminus \{p_g\}$ and signal s, define

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta P_{r,s}^{i,p_g} &:= P_{r,s}^{i} - P_{r,s}^{p_g}, \\ \Delta \Phi_{r,s}^{i,p_g} &:= \Phi_{r,s}^{i} - \Phi_{r,s}^{p_g}. \end{aligned} \tag{9}$$

Substituting Equations (4) and (5) and cancelling the receiver-side common terms ($c\,\mathrm{d}t_r$, $c\,\delta t_r^{(g)}$, $B_{r,s}$, $b_{r,s}$) yields

$$\boxed{\begin{aligned} \Delta P_{r,s}^{i,p_g} &= \Delta \rho_r^{i,p_g} - c\,\Delta \mathrm{d}t^{i,p_g} + \Delta T_r^{i,p_g} + \mu_s\,\Delta I_{r,1}^{i,p_g} - \Delta B_s^{i,p_g} + \Delta \varepsilon^{P}, \qquad (10) \\ \Delta \Phi_{r,s}^{i,p_g} &= \Delta \rho_r^{i,p_g} - c\,\Delta \mathrm{d}t^{i,p_g} + \Delta T_r^{i,p_g} - \mu_s\,\Delta I_{r,1}^{i,p_g} + \lambda_s\,\Delta N_{r,s}^{i,p_g} - \Delta b_s^{i,p_g} + \Delta \varepsilon^{\Phi}. \qquad (11) \end{aligned}}$$

The cancellations are exact only when both observations enter the filter with the same modelling: same tropospheric mapping (which is why ΔT is small but not zero), same antenna PCV correction, and so on.

Pivot transitions. When the incumbent pivot leaves the visible set, p_g is re-elected from the remaining satellites. The float ambiguities $\{\Delta N_{r,s}^{i,p_g^{\mathrm{old}}}\}_{i,s}$ must be re-expressed relative to p_g^{new}. Rather than discarding and re-seeding (which destroys the integer information accumulated since the last fix), the engine applies the linear S-transformation $\boldsymbol{x}^{\mathrm{new}} = \boldsymbol{S}\,\boldsymbol{x}^{\mathrm{old}}$ with $\boldsymbol{S}$ chosen so that $\Delta N_{r,s}^{p_g^{\mathrm{new}},p_g^{\mathrm{old}}}$ becomes the new reference (zero). The covariance transforms as $\boldsymbol{P}^{\mathrm{new}} = \boldsymbol{S}\,\boldsymbol{P}^{\mathrm{old}}\,\boldsymbol{S}^{\mathrm{T}}$. These are two distinct code paths sharing the algebra above: in PPP-RTK the pivot re-election and the "sticky-pivot" retention policy live in `filter/PivotManager`, whereas the baseline DD path performs the analogous re-reference through the ambiguity-rename S-transform in `filter/DdPivotManager`, governed by the `baseline.enable_pivot_handover` flag.

5.2 Between-receiver single difference (BRSD)

In baseline modes there is at least one rover r_{rov} and exactly one fixed-coordinate reference r_{ref}. The BRSD operator forms

$$\nabla P_{r_{\mathrm{rov}} r_{\mathrm{ref}},s}^{i} := P_{r_{\mathrm{rov}},s}^{i} - P_{r_{\mathrm{ref}},s}^{i}, \tag{12}$$

and analogously for $\nabla\Phi$. The cancellations produced by $\nabla\cdot$ are dual to those produced by $\Delta\cdot$: BRSD cancels *satellite*-side common terms ($c\,\mathrm{d}t^i$, B_s^i, b_s^i) but preserves receiver clock and biases of *both* stations. No state-space estimation of satellite biases is required when ∇ is applied — they disappear before reaching the filter.

5.3 Double difference (DD)

The composition $\nabla\Delta\cdot = \Delta(\nabla\,\cdot\,)$ is order-independent up to noise correlation: $\Delta(\nabla\,\cdot\,) = \nabla(\Delta\,\cdot\,)$. Applying it to the carrier-phase model and collecting common-mode cancellations:

$$\nabla\Delta\Phi^{i,p_g}_{r_{\mathrm{rov}}r_{\mathrm{ref}},s} \;=\; \nabla\Delta\rho^{i,p_g}_{r_{\mathrm{rov}}r_{\mathrm{ref}}} + \nabla\Delta T^{i,p_g}_{r_{\mathrm{rov}}r_{\mathrm{ref}}} - \mu_s\,\nabla\Delta I^{i,p_g}_{r_{\mathrm{rov}}r_{\mathrm{ref}},1} + \lambda_s\,\nabla\Delta N^{i,p_g}_{r_{\mathrm{rov}}r_{\mathrm{ref}},s} + \nabla\Delta\varepsilon^{\Phi}. \tag{13}$$

What survives in Equation (13) is precisely the geometry term (linear in the rover position perturbation), the differential atmospheric delays, and the integer DD ambiguity — the structural form that makes carrier-phase RTK possible.

Short vs. long baselines. On short baselines ($\lesssim 10\,\mathrm{km}$) the differential atmospheric terms in Equation (13) are negligible at the millimetre level and need not be modelled. As baseline length grows, the differential ionosphere $\nabla\Delta I$ scales linearly with separation and saturates at typically 1 m for separations of a few hundred kilometres, swamping the carrier wavelength. Two mitigations are available in `GnssProcessor`:

- `baseline.use_iono_free` forms the dual-frequency ionosphere-free combination at the DD level, eliminating the first-order ionospheric term at the cost of a non-integer ambiguity (AR is automatically excluded for IF rows) and $\sim 3\times$ amplified code noise;
- `baseline.estimate_differential_tropo` adds a single $\Delta\mathrm{ZWD}_{r_{\mathrm{rov}}r_{\mathrm{ref}}}$ state with slow random-walk dynamics, capturing the residual differential wet delay that survives the BRSD on baselines with significant altitude difference.

5.4 S-transform structure

Both BSSD and DD admit a matrix-form representation as $\boldsymbol{x}_{\mathrm{diff}} = \boldsymbol{S}\,\boldsymbol{x}_{\mathrm{undiff}}$ with $\boldsymbol{S}$ acting as a block design transform. For BSSD restricted to the ambiguity block of one constellation g on one signal s, with $|\mathcal{S}_g|$ tracked sats, $\boldsymbol{S}$ is a $(|\mathcal{S}_g|-1)\times|\mathcal{S}_g|$ matrix of the form

$$\boldsymbol{S}_{\mathrm{BSSD}} \;=\; \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & -1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & \cdots & 0 & -1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & & \ddots & & \vdots & & & \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & -1 & 0 & \cdots & 1 \end{bmatrix}, \tag{14}$$

where the column of -1's sits at the index of the pivot p_g. The DD operator is the *composition* of the two single-difference operators applied in sequence, $\boldsymbol{S}_{\mathrm{DD}} = \boldsymbol{S}_{\mathrm{BSSD}}\,\boldsymbol{S}_{\mathrm{BRSD}}$, realised in code as `BrsdTransform::apply` followed by `BssdTransform::differenceBrsd` (`include/measurement/BssdTransform.h`). Only on a fully populated satellite $\times$ receiver observation grid does this composition coincide with the Kronecker product $\mathbf{D}_{\mathrm{sat}}\otimes\mathbf{D}_{\mathrm{rx}}$ of the between-satellite and between-receiver differencing matrices acting on the vectorised observations — a useful mental model, but not what the non-rectangular real-data case computes. The transformed covariance is $\boldsymbol{P}_{\mathrm{diff}} = \boldsymbol{S}\,\boldsymbol{P}_{\mathrm{undiff}}\,\boldsymbol{S}^{\mathrm{T}}$, a generally dense matrix even when $\boldsymbol{P}_{\mathrm{undiff}}$ is diagonal (because each differenced row borrows from the same pivot column). This dense correlation structure is the algebraic reason DD-based filters cannot be naively implemented as independent per-pair scalar updates — the correctly correlated joint update is what unlocks integer ambiguity recovery via the LAMBDA decorrelation. The general theory and a thorough catalogue of admissible S-transforms is given in Teunissen [11] and in the rank-defect treatment of Jonge [4].

Implementation notes. Two facts about how `GnssProcessor` realises the transforms above are worth stating explicitly. First, the chosen S-system is never materialised as an explicit minimum-constraint $\boldsymbol{S}$-basis matrix; it is realised *implicitly* through the pivot-differencing operator (`measurement/BssdTransform`), a faithful, S-basis-invariant realisation of the uncombined parameterisation of Odijk [6]. The three regimes — undifferenced, BSSD, and DD — are dispatched polymorphically by a `DifferencingMode` strategy in `measurement/MeasurementBuilder`, not by inline config branches. Second, integer recovery on a DD row requires that all four contributing observations share the same RINEX signal code; *cross-attribute aliased* rows (rover code ≠ reference code, flagged `brsd_aliased` and not `integer_capable`) are carried as float and excluded from ambiguity resolution.

6 Estimation engine: the Kalman filter and RTS smoother

This section documents the recursive estimator at the core of the engine: a variable-dimension extended Kalman filter (EKF) with an optional prior-anchored iterated (IEKF) relinearisation pass, robust post-fit residual gating, and a backward Rauch–Tung–Striebel (RTS) smoother for post-processing modes. The state vector $\boldsymbol{x}$ is the uncombined PPP / PPP-RTK parameterisation of Section 5: receiver position (and optionally velocity), receiver clock and per-system time offsets, zenith wet troposphere and gradients, per-satellite slant ionosphere, receiver/satellite code and phase biases, and one float ambiguity per tracked carrier. Its dimension changes epoch to epoch as satellites rise and set and as ambiguities are reset; the layout and the dynamic key→index maps are owned exclusively by `filter/StateManager`, and the filter operates on that state without any fixed-index assumptions (`src/core/filter/KalmanFilter.cpp`).

Throughout we write $\boldsymbol{F}$ for the state-transition matrix, $\boldsymbol{Q}$ for the discrete process-noise covariance, $\boldsymbol{R}$ for the measurement-noise covariance, $\boldsymbol{S}$ for the innovation covariance, $\boldsymbol{K}$ for the Kalman gain, and $\boldsymbol{\nu}$ for the innovation (measurement minus predicted measurement). Predicted (a-priori) and updated (a-posteriori) quantities use the tilde/hat and $k|k{-}1$ / $k|k$ conditioning convention fixed in Section 2.

6.1 Time update

State transition. The transition matrix $\boldsymbol{F}(\Delta t)$ for epoch interval $\Delta t = t_k - t_{k-1}$ is identity plus a small number of coupling blocks, assembled by `StateManager::getTransitionMatrix` (`src/core/filter/StateManager.cpp`). The only off-diagonal couplings are the kinematic integrators

$$\boldsymbol{F}[\,\boldsymbol{r},\boldsymbol{v}\,] = \Delta t\,\boldsymbol{I}_3, \qquad \boldsymbol{F}[\,c\mathrm{d}t,\ c\dot{\mathrm{d}}t\,] = \Delta t, \qquad \boldsymbol{F}[\,c\delta t^{(g)},\ c\dot{\delta t}^{(g)}\,] = \Delta t, \tag{15}$$

present only when the corresponding rate state exists (`hasVelocity()`, clock-rate, per-system rate). Every remaining state — ambiguities, per-satellite ionosphere, zenith wet delay, gradients, code and satellite biases, and any rate-free inter-system offset — has $\boldsymbol{F} = \boldsymbol{I}$ and is propagated as a pure random walk with its mean held constant. Under the BSSD (single-difference) parameterisation the clock and inter-system-offset rows are unobservable; their position rows in Equation (15) are suppressed and the corresponding cross-covariances are zeroed in place after propagation while the diagonal variance is preserved (`src/core/filter/KalmanFilter.cpp`).

The propagation itself is the standard EKF time update

$$\boxed{\begin{aligned}\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k|k-1} &= \boldsymbol{F}(\Delta t)\,\hat{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k-1|k-1}, &(16)\\ \tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_{k|k-1} &= \boldsymbol{F}(\Delta t)\,\boldsymbol{P}_{k-1|k-1}\,\boldsymbol{F}(\Delta t)^{\mathrm{T}} + \boldsymbol{Q}(\Delta t), &(17)\end{aligned}}$$

implemented in `KalmanFilter::predict`. A non-positive Δt is treated as a no-op (duplicate or out-of-order epoch), short-circuiting before Equation (17).

Process-noise model. The discrete process noise $\boldsymbol{Q}(\Delta t)$ is built from continuous spectral densities by `StateManager::getProcessNoiseMatrix`. Two block structures appear. Pure random-walk states have a scalar discrete variance increment

$$\boldsymbol{Q}_{ii} = q_i \, \Delta t, \tag{18}$$

where q_i is the continuous variance rate (m^2/s) read from `filter.process_noise.*`. Representative entries are zenith wet troposphere (`troposphere_q`), the receiver code bias (`code_bias_q`), satellite phase bias (`sat_bias_q`), phase clock (`phase_clock_q`), and the float ambiguity (`ambiguity_q`). The ambiguity density defaults to a numerical safety floor (10^{-12}) rather than a physical value, and per-key overrides are supported for arc-specific reseeding. The per-satellite slant ionosphere uses a random walk whose zenith density is mapped to the slant by the squared obliquity factor,

$$\boldsymbol{Q}_{ii} = \frac{q_{\mathrm{iono}}}{\sin^2 \theta^i} \, \Delta t, \qquad \sin^2 \theta^i \text{ floored at } 10^{-2} \ (\theta \approx 5.7^\circ), \tag{19}$$

with $q_{\mathrm{iono}} =$ `ionosphere_q` and optional per-satellite overrides driven by the adaptive-iono scheme.

Coupled position/velocity, clock/clock-rate, and inter-system offset/rate pairs use the continuous white-noise-acceleration (CWNA, integrated-random-walk) discretisation. For a coupled pair $(\xi, \dot{\xi})$ driven by acceleration PSD q,

$$\boldsymbol{Q}_{[\xi,\dot{\xi}]} = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{3} q \, \Delta t^3 & \frac{1}{2} q \, \Delta t^2 \\ \frac{1}{2} q \, \Delta t^2 & q \, \Delta t \end{bmatrix}, \tag{20}$$

with q given by `acceleration_psd_q` (position/velocity, the 3×3 block-diagonal extension of Equation (20) over the ECEF axes), `clock_rate_q`, and `system_time_rate_offset_q` respectively. When the velocity state is present the rate-free position density `position_q` is unused. Baseline (double-difference) mode reduces $\boldsymbol{Q}$ to the position block, a per-ambiguity random-walk term, and an optional differential-ZWD entry $\boldsymbol{Q}_{ii} = \sigma^2 \Delta t$ governed by `baseline.differential_tropo_process_noise_m_per_sqrt_s`.

Aided time update. When inertial aiding is active, `KalmanFilter::predictImu` performs a strapdown mechanisation of the nominal position, velocity, and attitude and splices a 15×15 INS error-state transition $\boldsymbol{\Phi}$ and noise $\boldsymbol{Q}_{\mathrm{ins}}$ — with error order $[\delta\boldsymbol{p}, \delta\boldsymbol{v}, \delta\boldsymbol{\psi}, \delta\boldsymbol{b}_a, \delta\boldsymbol{b}_g]$ — into the GNSS-dimensioned $\boldsymbol{F}$ and $\boldsymbol{Q}$ over the integrated interval, after which Equation (17) runs on the full state with explicit symmetrisation $\boldsymbol{P} \leftarrow \frac{1}{2}(\boldsymbol{P} + \boldsymbol{P}^{\mathrm{T}})$. The generalised `predictAided` path applies the same splice for arbitrary aiding sources and delegates byte-identically to the GNSS-only Equation (17) when no aiding payload is present.

6.2 Measurement update

The measurement update (`KalmanFilter::update`) is a *batch* update: all observation rows of the epoch are processed simultaneously, not sequentially/scalar. A sparse-$\boldsymbol{H}$ optimisation accelerates the four design-matrix products ($\boldsymbol{HP}$, $\boldsymbol{HPH}^{\mathrm{T}}$, $\boldsymbol{KH}$, and the $\boldsymbol{H}$-touching parts of the gain), and is numerically identical to the dense computation to within a 10^{-12} structural threshold (`src/core/filter/KalmanFilter.cpp`).

Given the design matrix $\boldsymbol{H}$ from the linearisation of Equations (4) and (5) (position rows $-(\boldsymbol{e}^i_{\hat{r}})^{\mathrm{T}}$, Equation (6)), the innovation $\boldsymbol{\nu}$ (`measurement.innovations`), and the measurement-noise

covariance $\boldsymbol{R}$ — a full matrix when supplied, otherwise the diagonal $\boldsymbol{R} = \mathrm{diag}(\sigma^2_{r,i,s})$ of Equation (8) — the innovation covariance and gain are

$$\boldsymbol{S} = \boldsymbol{H}\,\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_{k|k-1}\,\boldsymbol{H}^{\mathrm{T}} + \boldsymbol{R}, \tag{21}$$

$$\boldsymbol{K} = \tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_{k|k-1}\,\boldsymbol{H}^{\mathrm{T}}\,\boldsymbol{S}^{-1}. \tag{22}$$

The gain is never formed by explicitly inverting $\boldsymbol{S}$. Exploiting the symmetry of $\boldsymbol{S}$, the engine factorises it once with an $\mathrm{LDL}^{\mathrm{T}}$ decomposition and recovers $\boldsymbol{K} = \left(\boldsymbol{S}^{-1}\boldsymbol{H}\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}\right)^{\mathrm{T}}$ from a single solve against $\boldsymbol{H}\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}$ (`ldlt.solve(HP).transpose()`); on factorisation failure it falls back to a complete-orthogonal (pseudo-inverse) solve. The state update is

$$\delta\boldsymbol{x} = \boldsymbol{K}\,\boldsymbol{\nu}, \qquad \hat{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k|k} = \tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k|k-1} + \delta\boldsymbol{x}. \tag{23}$$

Joseph-form covariance update. The covariance is updated in the numerically stabilised *Joseph* form, never the short form $(\boldsymbol{I} - \boldsymbol{K}\boldsymbol{H})\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}$:

$$\boxed{\boldsymbol{P}_{k|k} = (\boldsymbol{I} - \boldsymbol{K}\boldsymbol{H})\,\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_{k|k-1}\,(\boldsymbol{I} - \boldsymbol{K}\boldsymbol{H})^{\mathrm{T}} + \boldsymbol{K}\,\boldsymbol{R}\,\boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{T}}.} \tag{24}$$

The Joseph form preserves symmetry and positive semi-definiteness for any gain, which matters because the engine deliberately departs from the optimal gain in its robust paths (Section 6.4); the result is symmetrised once more, $\boldsymbol{P} \leftarrow \frac{1}{2}(\boldsymbol{P} + \boldsymbol{P}^{\mathrm{T}})$, to clear round-off. The factor $(\boldsymbol{I} - \boldsymbol{K}\boldsymbol{H})$ is assembled from the sparse $\boldsymbol{K}\boldsymbol{H}$ product with a unit shift on the diagonal. The same Joseph kernel, with the explicit gain $\boldsymbol{K} = \boldsymbol{P}\boldsymbol{H}^{\mathrm{T}}\boldsymbol{S}^{-1}$, is exposed as the pure static routine `josephPseudoUpdate` and reused for scalar pseudo-observation constraints (e.g. the GIM ionosphere prior via `applyPseudoObservation`) and for the IEKF pass of Section 6.3.

Post-fit residuals. After the update the post-fit residuals and their (diagonal) covariance are

$$\boldsymbol{r} = \boldsymbol{\nu} - \boldsymbol{H}\,\delta\boldsymbol{x}, \qquad S_{r,ii} = R_{ii} - \left(\boldsymbol{H}\,\boldsymbol{P}_{k|k}\,\boldsymbol{H}^{\mathrm{T}}\right)_{ii}, \tag{25}$$

of which only the diagonal of S_r is materialised. The standardised residual that drives gating (Section 6.4) is

$$s_i = \frac{r_i}{\sqrt{\max\{\, S_{r,ii},\, R_{ii},\, 10^{-12} \,\}}}. \tag{26}$$

The denominator floor at the *working* R_{ii} (the inflated noise actually used in $\boldsymbol{R}$, not the formal noise) is a deliberate robustness compromise: in ambiguity-absorption cases — double-differenced phase with an ambiguity gain near unity — the rigorous denominator $S_{r,ii}$ collapses toward $R\,\boldsymbol{S}^{-1}R$, which would register near-zero residuals as many-σ outliers. The strictly correct standardisation uses $S_{r,ii}$ alone; the floor trades that rigour for stability and is documented as such in source.

6.3 Iterated relinearisation (IEKF)

For long initial position offsets a single linearisation of Equation (6) per epoch can be insufficient. When `processing.relinearize_geometry` is enabled (and the run is not tightly-coupled IMU), the engine performs a prior-anchored iterated update — a Gauss–Newton / iterated EKF step — after the primary update.

Anchor. The iteration is anchored to the *stashed pre-update prior* $(\boldsymbol{x}^-, \boldsymbol{P}^-)$ that the converged primary Equations (17) and (24) read, captured only when relinearisation is armed (`getLastUpdatePriorX` / `getLastUpdatePriorP`). This is the prior *after* any in-epoch ambiguity augmentation and outlier reset, so it is dimension-matched to the posterior; it is not a top-of-loop snapshot.

Gauss–Newton step. Let $\boldsymbol{x}_i$ be the current linearisation iterate (the committed state at which `measurement` was linearised, with innovations $\boldsymbol{z} - h(\boldsymbol{x}_i)$ and $\boldsymbol{H} = \partial h/\partial \boldsymbol{x}\big|_{\boldsymbol{x}_i}$). The prior-anchored iterate (`KalmanFilter::updateFromPrior`, via `josephPseudoUpdate`) is

$$\boldsymbol{\nu} = \big(\boldsymbol{z} - h(\boldsymbol{x}_i)\big) - \boldsymbol{H}(\boldsymbol{x}^- - \boldsymbol{x}_i), \tag{27}$$

$$\boldsymbol{K} = \boldsymbol{P}^-\boldsymbol{H}^{\mathrm{T}}\big(\boldsymbol{H}\boldsymbol{P}^-\boldsymbol{H}^{\mathrm{T}} + \boldsymbol{R}\big)^{-1}, \qquad \boldsymbol{x}^+ = \boldsymbol{x}^- + \boldsymbol{K}\,\boldsymbol{\nu}, \tag{28}$$

$$\boldsymbol{P}^+ = (\boldsymbol{I} - \boldsymbol{K}\boldsymbol{H})\,\boldsymbol{P}^-\,(\boldsymbol{I} - \boldsymbol{K}\boldsymbol{H})^{\mathrm{T}} + \boldsymbol{K}\,\boldsymbol{R}\,\boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{T}}. \tag{29}$$

The offset term $-\boldsymbol{H}(\boldsymbol{x}^- - \boldsymbol{x}_i)$ in Equation (27) re-expresses the innovation about the fixed prior and is what makes this a proper MAP / Gauss–Newton iteration: because $\boldsymbol{K}$ and $(\boldsymbol{I} - \boldsymbol{K}\boldsymbol{H})\boldsymbol{P}^-$ are always derived from the same fixed prior $(\boldsymbol{x}^-, \boldsymbol{P}^-)$, the covariance does *not* contract a second time and no information is double-counted.

Firing condition. The driver `Application::runGeometryRelinearization` (`src/core/app/Application.cpp` fires the iteration when all of the following hold:

1. `processing.relinearize_geometry` is on and a prior was stashed at the primary update;
2. the position change since the primary update exceeds a data-dependent threshold — `relinearize_dpos_threshol` (default 1 m) when phase is present, or `relinearize_dpos_threshold_code_only_m` (default 100 m) for code-only epochs;
3. the per-run cap `relinearize_max_count` (-1 = unlimited) is not exhausted.

The inner loop recomputes geometry and re-applies Equations (27) to (29) against the *fixed* converged exclusion set, for at most five iterations, declaring convergence when the position step falls below 10^{-4} m. Because GNSS geometry is nearly linear at the metre level, convergence is typically reached in a single pass and the threshold of item 2 means the iteration rarely fires at all. The tightly-coupled IMU configuration instead takes a single legacy *naive* second pass (re-applying the measurement against the posterior), since error-state attitude/bias feedback conflicts with a clean prior re-derivation.

6.4 Innovation and residual gating

The engine performs *no* χ^2 innovation-covariance test. Outlier rejection (`KalmanFilter::validatePostFitResidua` operates on the standardised *post-fit* residuals s_i of Equation (26) against a fixed scalar threshold, supplemented by robust median-based spatial detectors for pivot slips. The two top-level thresholds are compile-time constants, *not* JSON-tunable: the per-row rejection threshold is $s_{\max} = 6.0$ (`getResidualThreshold`) and the complete-reset trigger fraction is 0.5 (`getBadMeasPercent`); readers should not search for config keys for these.

Per-row rejection. If $\max_i |s_i| > 6.0$, the worst row is dispatched by type: a phase outlier triggers an ambiguity reset (with BSSD pivot handling and a sub-cycle λ-fraction floor), while a code outlier is excluded from the epoch. Correlated same-satellite phase rows on other bands are reset alongside it.

Complete-reset backstop. If the count of rejected rows exceeds $0.5\times$(original pre-peel observation count), the filter covariance is re-inflated (`resetFilterCovariance`) — a hard reset that, in the smoother, marks a segment boundary (Section 6.5).

Robust pivot-slip detectors (BSSD). Before the per-row gate, single-difference phase rows are grouped by (pivot, signal) and screened for a coherent pivot slip using median / median-absolute-deviation (MAD) statistics: a forced pivot handover fires when a group is large enough, a majority of its rows exceed threshold, the group median exceeds a metre-scale floor, and the MAD-to-median ratio is small (a tight cluster indicating a common-mode shift rather than scattered noise). Cross-band pooled and code-side variants apply analogous tests with their own floors, and non-pivot multi-band slips are confirmed by integer-cycle consistency ($|r|/\lambda_{\text{band}}$ rounding to the same nonzero integer across bands).

Down-weighting (not gating). Two paths inflate $\boldsymbol{R}$ rather than reject: a persistent EWMA-bias term adds the squared mean bias to R_{ii} once an arc has warmed up, and a Huber post-fit scheme inflates R for sub-cycle rows whose $|s_i|$ exceeds the Huber knee (innovation one-shot or post-fit IRLS variants, toggled by `enable_huber_r_inflation` and `enable_huber_innovation`). These modify the working $\boldsymbol{R}$ that feeds Equations (21) and (26), and are the reason the standardised residual floors at the working noise rather than the formal noise.

6.5 Backward RTS smoother

In post-processing modes, enabling `processing.run_smoother` runs a fixed-interval Rauch–Tung–Striebel recursion [7] over the stored forward trajectory (`include/filter/Smoother.hpp`, `src/core/filter/Smoothe`). The flag is force-disabled under `AppMode::RealTime`, since smoothing is non-causal and inherently a post-processing operation.

Forward-pass capture. Rather than reconstruct the a-priori from $\boldsymbol{F}$ and $\boldsymbol{Q}$ on the backward pass, the forward pass caches, per epoch, both the one-step prediction $\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k|k-1}, \tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_{k|k-1}$ and the posterior $\hat{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k|k}, \boldsymbol{P}_{k|k}$, together with $\boldsymbol{F}_k$ and the full set of core and dynamic key→index maps (`capturePriorSnapshot` / `capturePosteriorSnapshot` in `src/core/app/Application.cpp`). A capture-ordering invariant makes the stored prior exactly $\boldsymbol{F}_k\hat{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k-1|k-1}$: the a-priori is recorded immediately after `predict()` and before any cycle-slip reseeding or measurement update, and the a-posteriori is recorded *before* integer ambiguity resolution, so the smoother consumes *float* ambiguities only.

Recursion. Initialised at the terminal posterior $\hat{\boldsymbol{x}}_{N|N} = \hat{\boldsymbol{x}}_{N|N}$, $\boldsymbol{P}_{N|N} = \boldsymbol{P}_{N|N}$, the backward recursion is

$$\boxed{\begin{aligned} \boldsymbol{G}_k &= \boldsymbol{P}_{k|k}\,\boldsymbol{F}_{k+1}^{\mathrm{T}}\,\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_{k+1|k}^{-1}, && (30)\\ \hat{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k|N} &= \hat{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k|k} + \boldsymbol{G}_k\big(\hat{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k+1|N} - \tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k+1|k}\big), && (31)\\ \boldsymbol{P}_{k|N} &= \boldsymbol{P}_{k|k} + \boldsymbol{G}_k\big(\boldsymbol{P}_{k+1|N} - \tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_{k+1|k}\big)\boldsymbol{G}_k^{\mathrm{T}}. && (32) \end{aligned}}$$

The smoother gain $\boldsymbol{G}_k$ is realised as an $\mathrm{LDL}^{\mathrm{T}}$ solve — the predicted covariance is symmetrised, then $\boldsymbol{G}_k = \big(\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_{k+1|k}^{-1}(\boldsymbol{P}_{k|k}\boldsymbol{F}^{\mathrm{T}})^{\mathrm{T}}\big)^{\mathrm{T}}$ via `ldlt.solve(...).transpose()` — never an explicit inverse, and the smoothed covariance Equation (32) is symmetrised after the update. If the factorisation fails, the step is abandoned and epoch k keeps its forward posterior.

Variable-dimension reconciliation. Because $\dim \boldsymbol{x}_k \neq \dim \boldsymbol{x}_{k+1}$ in general, Equations (30) to (32) are restricted at each step to the *common-key subspace* — the states present at both k and $k{+}1$, found by intersecting the dynamic key→index maps (`collectCommonIndices`). Let $\boldsymbol{\Pi}_k$ and $\boldsymbol{\Pi}_{k+1}$ select the common rows in each epoch's state space; the implemented state update is then

$$\hat{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k|N} = \hat{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k|k} + \boldsymbol{\Pi}_k^{\mathrm{T}}\, \boldsymbol{G}_{k,C}\big(\boldsymbol{\Pi}_{k+1}\hat{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k+1|N} - \boldsymbol{\Pi}_k\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k+1|k}\big), \tag{33}$$

with the analogous projection on Equation (32). States outside the subspace retain their forward a-posteriori value. A subtle indexing invariant: $\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k+1|k}$, $\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_{k+1|k}$ and $\boldsymbol{F}_{k+1}$ are sized for epoch k's layout (the predict step does not grow the state), so they are addressed with epoch k's common indices, whereas $\hat{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k+1|N}$, $\boldsymbol{P}_{k+1|N}$ live in epoch $k{+}1$'s layout.

Segment boundaries at ambiguity resets. Two mechanisms of differing severity terminate or trim backward information flow at ambiguity resets:

- A *complete* filter reset at $k{+}1$ (the covariance re-inflation of Section 6.4, recorded as `is_discontinuity`) is a hard segment boundary: it severs the dynamic link $\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k+1|k} = \boldsymbol{F}\hat{\boldsymbol{x}}_{k|k}$, so no $\boldsymbol{G}_k$ is meaningful and backward flow is terminated — epoch k keeps its forward posterior.
- A *single-satellite* ambiguity reset is handled softly: that satellite's ambiguities are excluded from the common subspace for the $k \to k{+}1$ step, because the re-seeded large-variance prior at $k{+}1$ carries no information backward and smoothing it would only inject noise. The exclusion matches by satellite prefix and is intentionally slightly over-broad, always erring toward the safe forward fallback.

Static-position degeneracy. In static PPP the receiver position is a (near-)constant state, so the position-block smoother gain propagates essentially the same correction to every epoch and the smoothed position is degenerate — constant across epochs — *by construction*. This is expected, not a defect: the smoother's value accrues on the non-position states (troposphere, ionosphere, float ambiguities) and on kinematic runs where position carries genuine epoch-to-epoch dynamics.

7 Cycle-slip detection and repair

The uncombined filter (Section 4) never forms a linear combination on the measurement-update path: per-signal $P^i_{r,s}$ and $\Phi^i_{r,s}$ enter Equations (4) and (5) directly. Cycle slips are instead screened by a bank of *diagnostic* combinations, each constructed so that the geometric range ρ^i_r, the clocks $c(\mathrm{d}t_r - \mathrm{d}t^i)$ and the troposphere T^i_r cancel, leaving an observable whose only between-epoch variation is measurement noise plus any integer carrier discontinuity. The active detectors are Melbourne–Wübbena (`src/core/slip/MwSlipDetector.cpp`, the primary) and GRAPHIC (`src/core/slip/GraphicSlipDetector.cpp`); the extra-wide-lane detector (`src/core/slip/EwlSlipDetector.cp`) runs when a third frequency is present. The geometry-free and ionosphere-free phase detectors (`src/core/slip/GfSlipDetector.cpp`, `src/core/slip/IfPhaseSlipDetector.cpp`) are staged — present in the tree but not compiled into the current build — and their algebra is recorded here for completeness. The slip bank is enabled per detector under the config key `estimation.cycle_slip`.

Throughout this section we suppress the receiver index r (single-receiver PPP / PPP-RTK) and write $f_1 > f_2$ for the two carriers of a band pair, sorted by frequency so that $f_1 - f_2 > 0$ and $\lambda_1 < \lambda_2$ (`src/core/slip/MwSlipDetector.cpp`, the band-frequency sort). Carrier phase is read from RINEX in cycles and scaled by $\lambda_s = c/f_s$ before combining, so Φ^i_s below is always in metres, consistent with Equation (5). We reserve the operator $\delta\cdot$ for a *temporal* integer slip step (e.g. δN_s

is the change in the ambiguity on signal s across the slip epoch); this is deliberately distinct from the between-satellite single difference $\Delta\cdot$ of Section 5, which also uses Δ.

7.1 Test-statistic combinations

7.1.1 Melbourne–Wübbena (wide-lane)

The Melbourne–Wübbena (MW) observable is the wide-lane carrier phase minus the narrow-lane code. Introducing the wide- and narrow-lane wavelengths

$$\lambda_{\mathrm{WL}} \;:=\; \frac{c}{f_1 - f_2}, \qquad \lambda_{\mathrm{NL}} \;:=\; \frac{c}{f_1 + f_2}, \tag{34}$$

the engine forms (`MwSlipDetector::computeMwMeters`)

$$\boxed{\mathrm{MW}^i \;=\; \underbrace{\frac{f_1\,\Phi_1^i - f_2\,\Phi_2^i}{f_1 - f_2}}_{\text{wide-lane phase}} \;-\; \underbrace{\frac{f_1\,P_1^i + f_2\,P_2^i}{f_1 + f_2}}_{\text{narrow-lane code}}}. \tag{35}$$

The range-additive terms common to Equations (4) and (5) — geometry, clocks, troposphere — cancel between the two bracketed combinations. The slant ionosphere also cancels: the wide-lane phase carries the ionospheric coefficient $-(f_1\mu_1 - f_2\mu_2)/(f_1 - f_2)$ and the narrow-lane code carries $+(f_1\mu_1 + f_2\mu_2)/(f_1 + f_2)$, and with $\mu_s = f_1^2/f_s^2$ (Equation (1)) these two coefficients are equal, so the difference (35) removes the ionosphere exactly to first order. What remains is a near-constant equal to the wide-lane ambiguity plus hardware bias,

$$\mathrm{MW}^i \;\approx\; \lambda_{\mathrm{WL}}\, N_{\mathrm{WL}}^i \;+\; b_{\mathrm{MW}}^i \;+\; \varepsilon_{\mathrm{MW}}, \qquad N_{\mathrm{WL}}^i = N_1^i - N_2^i, \tag{36}$$

so a wide-lane slip $\delta N_{\mathrm{WL}} = \delta N_1 - \delta N_2$ appears as a step of $\lambda_{\mathrm{WL}}\,\delta N_{\mathrm{WL}}$. For GPS L1/L2, $\lambda_{\mathrm{WL}} \approx 0.861\,\mathrm{m}$ while the dominant error is the metre-level narrow-lane *code* noise; with code noise $\sigma_P \sim 0.3\,\mathrm{m}$ the MW noise is $\sigma_{\mathrm{MW}} \approx \sigma_P/(\sqrt{2}\,\lambda_{\mathrm{WL}}) \sim 0.25$ wide-lane cycles, i.e. code-noise-limited. The integer-ready (BIA-corrected) variant subtracts the satellite MW bias b_{MW}^i, which has the same algebra as Equation (35) applied to the OSB phase and code biases of Equations (4) and (5).

The level series $\mathrm{MW}^i(k)$ is screened against a robust adaptive gate whose deviation statistic is configurable via `estimation.cycle_slip.mw_detect_reference`. The recommended — and replay-default — choice is the first time difference $\mathrm{TD1}(k) = \mathrm{MW}^i(k) - \mathrm{MW}^i(k-1)$, gated against the median-absolute-deviation of its own history; the second time difference $\mathrm{TD2}(k) = \mathrm{MW}^i(k) - 2\,\mathrm{MW}^i(k-1) + \mathrm{MW}^i(k-2)$ is available (`mw_td_order`) for curvature immunity at a $\sqrt{6}$ noise penalty versus the $\sqrt{2}$ of TD1 (the white-noise scaling of each statistic is the single source of truth in `MwSlipDetector::activeStatScale`). A windowed local median and the legacy Hatch-mean reference are retained for A/B comparison (`local_median`, `hatch_mean`). The threshold itself is fully data-driven — no stochastic-model σ enters — combining a per-arc MAD, an EWMA-smoothed cross-satellite MAD floor and an elevation $1/\sin\theta$ shape, with a breadth cascade (band-pair → constellation → global-no-GLONASS) for sparse or cold-start arcs; the empirical construction lives in `MwSlipDetector::computeAdaptiveThreshold` and is intentionally not reproduced here.

7.1.2 Extra-wide-lane (EWL)

For three-or-more frequency satellites the same MW algebra (Equation (35)) is applied to a pair of *non-L1* carriers (`EwlSlipDetector::computeEwlMwMeters`; band digit ≥ 2). Because the two

carriers are spectrally close — $f_1 - f_2$ small — the extra-wide-lane wavelength

$$\lambda_{\mathrm{EWL}} \;=\; \frac{c}{f_1 - f_2} \tag{37}$$

is very long: GPS L2/L5 gives $\lambda_{\mathrm{EWL}} \approx 5.86\,\mathrm{m}$ and Galileo E5a/E5b $\approx 9.77\,\mathrm{m}$. Metre-level code noise then maps to $\lesssim 0.05$ EWL cycles, so the EWL integer $N_{\mathrm{EWL}} = N_2 - N_5$ resolves in a single epoch and a slip δN_{EWL} is sized with near-certainty. Together with the L1/L2 wide-lane (Equation (36)) this yields two independent band-difference constraints,

$$\delta N_{\mathrm{WL}} = \delta N_1 - \delta N_2, \qquad \delta N_{\mathrm{EWL}} = \delta N_2 - \delta N_5, \tag{38}$$

narrowing the per-signal triple $(\delta N_1, \delta N_2, \delta N_5)$ to a single remaining degree of freedom [2].

7.1.3 GRAPHIC (single-frequency half-sum)

The GRAPHIC combination averages the code and phase on a *single* band (`GraphicSlipDetector::computeGraphi`

$$\mathrm{GR}^i_s \;=\; \tfrac{1}{2}\big(P^i_s + \Phi^i_s\big), \tag{39}$$

with Φ^i_s in metres. Because the slant ionosphere enters $+\mu_s I^i_{r,1}$ on the code and $-\mu_s I^i_{r,1}$ on the phase of the *same* signal (Equations (4) and (5)), the half-sum cancels it to first order — GRAPHIC is ionosphere-free without a second frequency, at the cost of retaining half the code noise. The combination still contains the geometric range, clocks and troposphere plus the constant half-ambiguity $\frac{1}{2}\lambda_s N^i_s$, so the between-epoch first difference

$$\mathrm{dGR}^i_s(k) \;=\; \mathrm{GR}^i_s(k) - \mathrm{GR}^i_s(k-1) \tag{40}$$

removes the constant ambiguity (and cancels range and clocks down to receiver-motion / code-noise level). A δN-cycle slip on signal s therefore produces a jump of $\frac{1}{2}\lambda_s\,\delta N$, and the integer estimate is $\delta N = \mathrm{round}\big(2\,\mathrm{dGR}/\lambda_s\big)$. With $\sigma_P \sim 0.3\,\mathrm{m}$ the post-difference noise is $\sim 0.3\,\mathrm{m}$, so sensitivity is noise-limited to a few L1 cycles; in practice a hard floor `kMinThresholdM` $= 0.5\,\mathrm{m}$ governs on quiet arcs (≈ 5 L1 cycles), keeping GRAPHIC a coarse backstop rather than a sub-cycle detector [1, 14].

7.1.4 Geometry-free phase (staged)

The geometry-free (GF) observable is the between-band phase difference

$$\mathrm{GF}^i \;=\; \Phi^i_1 - \Phi^i_2 \;\approx\; (\mu_2 - \mu_1)\, I^i_{r,1} \;+\; (\lambda_1 N^i_1 - \lambda_2 N^i_2), \tag{41}$$

which removes geometry, clocks and troposphere exactly but retains the *difference* of the two ionospheric delays. Since $I^i_{r,1}$ varies smoothly, a second-order time difference

$$\mathrm{TD2}_{\mathrm{GF}}(k) \;=\; \mathrm{GF}^i(k) - 2\,\mathrm{GF}^i(k-1) + \mathrm{GF}^i(k-2) \tag{42}$$

cancels the ionospheric trend up to quadratic order over the sampling interval, leaving noise plus slip (`GfSlipDetector::computeGfMeters` for Equation (41); the TD2 update is the level-jump test statistic). The detector is intrinsically high-rate ($\geq 1\,\mathrm{Hz}$): at coarse rate the residual ionospheric curvature defeats (42). It is present in the tree but excluded from the build; the same algebra backs the active `src/core/slip/IonoVariabilityMonitor.cpp`.

7.1.5 Ionosphere-free phase (staged)

The dual-frequency ionosphere-free (IF) phase combination uses the coefficients

$$c_1 = \frac{f_1^2}{f_1^2 - f_2^2}, \qquad c_2 = \frac{f_2^2}{f_1^2 - f_2^2}, \qquad c_1 - c_2 = 1, \tag{43}$$

giving $\Phi^i_{\mathrm{IF}} = c_1\Phi^i_1 - c_2\Phi^i_2$ and the effective wavelength $\lambda_{\mathrm{IF}} = \left|c_1\lambda_1 - c_2\lambda_2\right|$ (`IfPhaseSlipDetector::computeIfWavel` for GPS L1/L2 $\lambda_{\mathrm{IF}} \approx 0.107\,\mathrm{m}$. Rather than screen the raw combination, the staged detector forms the IF observed-minus-computed (OMC), differences it between satellites against a high-elevation pivot p_g to remove the receiver clock, the inter-system offset $c\,\delta t_r^{(g)}$ and the satellite phase clock, then between epochs to remove the slowly-varying wet troposphere and the constant ambiguity:

$$\nabla\Delta\Phi^{i,p_g}_{\mathrm{IF}}(k) = \left[\Phi^i_{\mathrm{IF}}(k) - \Phi^{p_g}_{\mathrm{IF}}(k)\right] - \left[\Phi^i_{\mathrm{IF}}(k-1) - \Phi^{p_g}_{\mathrm{IF}}(k-1)\right], \tag{44}$$

which is near zero for a clean arc and jumps by $\sim \delta N\,\lambda_{\mathrm{IF}}$ on a slip. The between-satellite step does not cancel the differential geometric error $(\boldsymbol{e}^i - \boldsymbol{e}^{p_g})^{\mathrm{T}}\delta\boldsymbol{r}$, so flagging must be gated by the filter's 3D position sigma; this restricts the staged detector to a static site with a precise a priori position, which is why `estimation.enable_if_slip_detector` is currently inert.

7.2 TurboEdit dual-frequency resolution

The TurboEdit resolver (`src/core/slip/TurboEditResolver.cpp`, `include/slip/TurboEditResolver.hpp`) is a *pure* MW+GF joint integer solver. It owns the per-arc geometry-free jump history and the integer arithmetic, and returns per-signal integer repairs plus a reset-fallback set without mutating filter state; it is wired into both the post-processing `CycleSlipManager` and the real-time engine, and enabled by `estimation.cycle_slip.turbo_edit`.

7.2.1 The 2×2 system

For a dual-frequency phase pair (s_1, s_2) on satellite i, ordered higher-frequency first ($f_{s_1} > f_{s_2}$, hence $\lambda_{s_1} < \lambda_{s_2}$), the resolver pairs two scalar slip observables. The first is the MW wide-lane integer of Equation (36), taken *as input* from the MW detector and never recomputed (the empirically tuned MW path of Section 7.1.1 is the single source of δN_{WL}):

$$\delta N_{\mathrm{WL}} \;=\; \delta N_{s_1} - \delta N_{s_2} \qquad \text{(one equation, two unknowns).} \tag{45}$$

The second is the GF phase jump in metres. Writing the GF level as $\mathrm{GF}(t) = \lambda_{s_1}L_{s_1}(t) - \lambda_{s_2}L_{s_2}(t)$ (carrier in cycles), a simultaneous slip steps its ambiguity content by

$$\delta\mathrm{GF} \;=\; \lambda_{s_1}\,\delta N_{s_1} - \lambda_{s_2}\,\delta N_{s_2}, \tag{46}$$

estimated in-arc by the second-order time difference $\mathrm{TD2}(t) = \mathrm{GF}(t) - 2\,\mathrm{GF}(t-1) + \mathrm{GF}(t-2)$ of Equation (42), which cancels the ionospheric delay up to quadratic order so that at the slip epoch it equals the integer jump plus phase noise only. The TD2 chain requires three *consecutive* epochs; non-consecutive history forces a chain re-seed (Section 7.2.4).

Stacking Equations (45) and (46) gives the linear map from the integer slip pair to the two observed jumps:

$$\boxed{\begin{pmatrix}\delta N_{\mathrm{WL}}\\ \delta\mathrm{GF}\end{pmatrix} \;=\; \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix}1 & -1\\ \lambda_{s_1} & -\lambda_{s_2}\end{pmatrix}}_{\boldsymbol{A}} \begin{pmatrix}\delta N_{s_1}\\ \delta N_{s_2}\end{pmatrix}.} \tag{47}$$

The determinant $\det \boldsymbol{A} = \lambda_{s_1} - \lambda_{s_2}$ is non-zero for any genuine cross-band pair — it is the cm-scale quantity `denom` of Equation (49), $\approx -0.0539\,\mathrm{m}$ for GPS L1/L2, *not* the $\sim 0.86\,\mathrm{m}$ wide-lane wavelength — so the system is always invertible:

$$\boldsymbol{A}^{-1} = \frac{1}{\lambda_{s_1} - \lambda_{s_2}} \begin{pmatrix} -\lambda_{s_2} & 1 \\ -\lambda_{s_1} & 1 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{48}$$

The implementation does not invert the full matrix; it solves the second row for δN_{s_2} and back-substitutes the first (`TurboEditResolver.cpp`):

$$\delta N_{s_2} \;=\; \frac{\delta\mathrm{GF} - \lambda_{s_1}\,\delta N_{\mathrm{WL}}}{\lambda_{s_1} - \lambda_{s_2}}, \qquad \delta N_{s_1} \;=\; \delta N_{s_2} + \delta N_{\mathrm{WL}}, \tag{49}$$

with δGF instantiated either by the in-arc TD2 or, across a data gap, by the bridged jump of Section 7.2.4. The denominator $\lambda_{s_1} - \lambda_{s_2}$ (the variable `denom` in the source) equals $\approx -0.0539\,\mathrm{m}$ for GPS L1/L2, so the amplification factor on the wide-lane integer is $\lambda_{s_1}/(\lambda_{s_1} - \lambda_{s_2}) \approx -3.53$: the GF equation must localise δN_{s_2} to well within ± 0.5 cycle despite that lever, which is what the split-capability gate below enforces.

7.2.2 Integer rounding and validation

The float δN_{s_2} from Equation (49) is rounded and its residual recorded:

$$d_2 = \mathrm{round}\big(\delta N_{s_2}\big), \quad f = \big|\delta N_{s_2} - d_2\big|, \quad d_1 = d_2 + \delta N_{\mathrm{WL}}. \tag{50}$$

A candidate is *accepted* as a repair only if the rounding is clean ($f \le 0.30$, the constant `kMaxFractional`; a $1 - 0.30 = 0.70$ cycle margin to the nearest wrong integer), the magnitudes are sane ($|d_1|, |d_2| \le$ `kMaxSlipCycles`), and the pair is non-trivial ($d_1 \neq 0 \vee d_2 \neq 0$). A non-trivial accepted candidate yields `action="repair"`; $(d_1, d_2) = (0, 0)$ is resolved as no-slip and the arc keeps rolling; otherwise the satellite is reset.

Before the joint solve is *trusted*, the GF evidence must be sharp enough to discriminate the integer lattice. The float δN_{s_2} carries $\sigma_{\mathrm{TD2}}/|\lambda_{s_1} - \lambda_{s_2}|$ cycles of noise, so the solve is permitted only when

$$\sigma_{\mathrm{TD2}} \;\le\; \texttt{turbo_edit_split_max_sigma} \cdot \big|\lambda_{s_1} - \lambda_{s_2}\big| \qquad (\texttt{splitCapable}), \tag{51}$$

with σ_{TD2} the arc's own MAD-derived σ when mature, else the cross-satellite tier floor, else NaN (NaN fails by design — "no estimate" is not evidence of sharpness). The default `estimation.cycle_slip.turbo_edit_spl` is 0.2 cycles. This gate is the single mechanism making the resolver rate-adaptive: millimetric 1 s noise passes trivially, while coarse-rate (30 s) ionospheric residual passes only while the arc is quiet. On an MW-flagged pair failing the gate the resolver falls back to a satellite reset; a GF-only exceedance on a split-incapable arc is *ignored*, not reset. When $\delta N_{\mathrm{WL}} = 0$ (an equal slip $\delta N_{s_1} = \delta N_{s_2}$, to which MW is blind) a GF-only flag fires on |TD2| exceeding an adaptive threshold $\tau = \max(k_\sigma \hat{\sigma}_{\mathrm{TD2}}, 0.04\,\mathrm{m})$, with k_σ the `turbo_edit_sigma_multiplier`; the floor sits just below $|\lambda_{s_1} - \lambda_{s_2}| \approx 0.054\,\mathrm{m}$ so a ± 1-cycle equal slip remains detectable.

7.2.3 MW-only / code-event null line

The asymmetric case is MW flagged but the GF jump *affirmatively zero*. For a fixed $\delta N_{\mathrm{WL}} = k$, every integer pair $(\delta N_{s_1}, \delta N_{s_1} - k)$ predicts, via Equation (46), a GF jump

$$\delta\mathrm{GF} \;=\; \lambda_{s_2} k - (\lambda_{s_2} - \lambda_{s_1})\,\delta N_{s_1}, \tag{52}$$

whose zero crossing sits at $\delta N_{s_1} = \lambda_{s_2} k/(\lambda_{s_2} - \lambda_{s_1}) \approx 4.53\,k$ for GPS L1/L2 ($\approx 3.95\,k$ for L1/L5). Every small pair $|\delta N_{s_1}| \le 3$ then predicts $|\delta\mathrm{GF}| \ge 8\,\mathrm{cm}$ — orders above phase noise — so a flat GF leaves only *null-line* pairs of $(4,3)$ / $(9,7)$-class magnitude: implausible multi-cycle simultaneous slips on both signals with no loss of lock. The Occam-simpler explanation is a narrow-lane *code* excursion (multipath, NLOS, DLL re-lock), since $\mathrm{MW} = \Phi_{\mathrm{WL}} - P_{\mathrm{NL}}$ and one wide-lane cycle $\approx 0.86\,\mathrm{m}$ of narrow-lane code.

Accordingly the pair is classified a code-domain artifact — and the caller *skips* the phase reset — when the GF jump is affirmatively zero within a discrimination-bounded gate,

$$|\mathrm{TD2}| \le \underbrace{\texttt{kCodeEventZeroSigma} \cdot \hat{\sigma}_{\mathrm{MAD}}}_{\text{zero gate}} \quad \wedge \quad \text{zero gate} \le \underbrace{\texttt{kVetoZeroGateMaxLambdaFrac} \cdot |\lambda_{s_1} - \lambda_{s_2}|}_{\text{discrimination cap}}, \tag{53}$$

with `kCodeEventZeroSigma` $= 3.5$ ($\approx 99.95\%$ two-sided) and `kVetoZeroGateMaxLambdaFrac` $= 0.5$. The cap is the rate-adaptive safeguard: a zero gate wider than half the smallest GF-visible quantum cannot distinguish stillness from a small slip, so the veto stands down and the MW mandate governs. The classification is further trust-gated — veto enabled, MW flagged, GF not exceeding, no post-slip cooldown, ionospherically stable constellation, no LLI on either signal, and MAD maturity ≥ 10 samples (stricter than detection's 5, because affirming stillness is a state-*preserving* decision). The implied null-line pair is computed for the trace only, never applied; `did_slip` stays false so the GF chain keeps rolling. A genuine null-line slip is not lost: it jumps that signal's Kalman phase innovation by $\ge |4\lambda_{s_1}| \approx 0.76\,\mathrm{m}$ this very epoch, far beyond any residual gate, so the residual-driven reset corrects it one epoch late. The behaviour is toggled by `estimation.cycle_slip.turbo_edit_mw_only_veto` (default on).

7.2.4 Gap-spanning GF bridge

The TD2 chain needs three consecutive epochs; any per-signal dropout or receiver gap re-seeds the chain, making the post-gap TD2 *blind* to a re-lock slip whose GF level jump lives *between* the two chains. When a chain break occurs within `estimation.cycle_slip.turbo_edit_max_gap_s`, the resolver stashes the pre-gap GF level $\mathrm{GF}_{\mathrm{ref}}$, its timestamp, the arc's EWMA GF rate $\dot{\mathrm{GF}}$ and the pre-gap spacing dt_0, and on return forms the drift-corrected across-gap jump

$$\boxed{\delta\mathrm{GF}_{\mathrm{gap}} \;=\; \mathrm{GF}_{\mathrm{now}} - \mathrm{GF}_{\mathrm{ref}} - \dot{\mathrm{GF}}\,\Delta t, \qquad \Delta t = t_{\mathrm{now}} - t_{\mathrm{ref}},} \tag{54}$$

which then plays the role of $\delta\mathrm{GF}$ in Equation (49). Here $\dot{\mathrm{GF}}$ is an EWMA ($\alpha = 0.1$) of the per-epoch GF rate, chosen so its noise does not amplify when projected over the gap. Because the un-cancelled ionospheric residual is random-walk over the gap, the detection threshold and the code-event zero gate are widened by the factor $w = \sqrt{\Delta t/dt_0}$ (for $\Delta t > dt_0$), and the split-capability σ becomes $\sigma_{\mathrm{bridge}} = \hat{\sigma}_{\mathrm{MAD}}\, w$; the zero-gate *discrimination cap* stays un-widened, since the integer lattice of Equation (47) does not stretch with the gap. The bridge cap default is 15 s in code, raised to 60 s in the bundled real-time and replay configs.

An MW-flagged pair across the gap is attributed three ways. (i) A *code event* (`action="code_event"`) when $\delta\mathrm{GF}_{\mathrm{gap}}$ is affirmatively zero within the widened gate — the same null-line logic as Equation (53), applied across the gap — preserving phase through a re-acquisition DLL transient. (ii) A *repair* or *moot* when the joint solve runs with $\delta\mathrm{GF} = \delta\mathrm{GF}_{\mathrm{gap}}$; per signal it is dispatched by observation-domain continuity, a signal observed at every epoch through the gap kept its ambiguity (its nonzero δN is a genuine *repair*), whereas a signal that missed an epoch was pruned-and-reseeded on return (its nonzero δN is *moot* — already absorbed, mandate suppressed). (iii) A *reset* when the across-gap σ is too coarse for the split, or the candidate set fits zero or two integers with no deferral.

Because the GF equation alone is degenerate along the null-line lattice of Equation (52) — $+0.735\,\mathrm{m}$ fits both $(0, -3)$ and $(9, 4)$ at millimetre level; only the integer k separates them — the bridged solve demands a *unique* surviving candidate after three guards: the fractional gate of Equation (50); a GF-separation guard requiring the candidate's own predicted jump to clear the zero gate, $|\lambda_{s_1} d_1 - \lambda_{s_2} d_2| > \texttt{zero_gate}$, lest a marginal noise exceedance mint a multi-cycle repair from noise; and a sibling-pair zero affirmation, whereby a satellite's *other* GF arc that stayed chain-continuous and unflagged through the bridged interval affirms $\delta N = 0$ for both its signals and prunes any candidate demanding a nonzero integer on an affirmed signal. The wide-lane integer feeding the bridged solve is taken in trust order: the published MW integer k; failing that, at the flag epoch, $\mathrm{round}(f) \pm 3$ around the (NL-code-biased) instantaneous re-acquisition float; and on deferral epochs the settled across-gap MW Hatch mean. When the float wide-lane evidence is unsettled or the lattice is ambiguous (two or more acceptable integers), the solve is *deferred* rather than guessed (`estimation.cycle_slip.turbo_edit_wl_settle_max_s`), terminating in a later repair, reset or timeout-reset.

7.2.5 Atomic reconciliation

Per-satellite candidates are reconciled atomically: a cross-pair integer disagreement on a shared signal demotes the whole satellite to reset, and a satellite ending in the reset set has its code-event, moot, clean and pending classifications *withdrawn* — contradictory evidence always resolves to the conservative outcome. Arc bookkeeping keeps the TD2 validity precondition honest: a non-consecutive update partially resets the chain but preserves the slowly-varying MAD calibration window, an absolute gap beyond the configured maximum wipes the arc, and an accepted slip re-seeds with a short cooldown to suppress the TD2 echo; only clean (non-exceeding, non-bridged) TD2 samples feed the MAD window.

8 Integer ambiguity resolution

Integer ambiguity resolution (AR) converts the real-valued, bias-contaminated phase ambiguities of the float solution into the integer carrier-cycle counts they represent. The engine implements MLAMBDA [12] over a between-satellite-differenced ambiguity sub-problem extracted from the filter state and covariance. The operative quantity is the ambiguity differenced against a per-constellation pivot p_g (Section 5); the same integer-estimation machinery serves both the single-receiver and the baseline modes, but *what makes that differenced ambiguity an integer differs by mode.* The undifferenced ambiguity $N^i_{r,s}$ of Equation (5) carries a receiver phase bias $b_{r,s}$ and a satellite phase bias b^i_s. In single-receiver PPP / PPP-RTK the pivot difference is a *between-satellite single difference* $\Delta\cdot$ (Section 5.1), which cancels the receiver bias $b_{r,s}$ (common to every tracked satellite) but *not* the satellite bias; the residual $\Delta N^{i,p_g}_{r,s}$ is integer only once b^i_s has been removed by a consistent external phase-bias product (BIA / SSR, Section 10). In baseline mode the state already holds true double differences $\nabla\Delta\cdot$ (Section 5.3), where the additional between-receiver difference cancels the satellite bias as well, so $\nabla\Delta N$ is integer intrinsically. We retain the resolver's internal label $\nabla\Delta$ for the differenced ambiguity in the equations below — the algebra is identical either way — with the understanding that it denotes the between-satellite single difference Δ in the single-receiver case and the full double difference only in baseline mode. The implementation lives in `src/core/filter/AmbiguityResolver.cpp` (driver, search kernel, WL/NL decomposition, acceptance) with configuration under the JSON path `estimation.ambiguity_resolution.*`.

8.1 The integer least-squares problem

The float solution delivers a real-valued ambiguity estimate $\hat{\boldsymbol{N}}$ (in cycles) with covariance $\boldsymbol{Q}_{\hat{N}}$, both obtained by sub-vector extraction from the filter state $\boldsymbol{x}$ and covariance $\boldsymbol{P}$. Integer ambiguity resolution is the weighted closest-lattice-point problem

$$\boxed{\check{\boldsymbol{N}} \;=\; \arg\min_{\boldsymbol{a}\,\in\,\mathbb{Z}^n} \big(\hat{\boldsymbol{N}}-\boldsymbol{a}\big)^{\mathrm{T}}\,\boldsymbol{Q}_{\hat{N}}^{-1}\,\big(\hat{\boldsymbol{N}}-\boldsymbol{a}\big),} \tag{55}$$

i.e. minimisation of the squared Mahalanobis distance from $\hat{\boldsymbol{N}}$ to a lattice point $\boldsymbol{a}$ in the metric of $\boldsymbol{Q}_{\hat{N}}^{-1}$. This is an NP-hard integer least-squares (ILS) program; LAMBDA and its MLAMBDA variant make it tractable in three invariant stages — (i) an LDL^{T} factorisation of $\boldsymbol{Q}_{\hat{N}}$, (ii) a decorrelating integer $\boldsymbol{Z}$-transform (lattice reduction), and (iii) a depth-first shrinking-ellipsoid search over the reduced lattice — none of which carries a tuning parameter. We follow the hat/check convention of the notation block: $\hat{\boldsymbol{N}}$ is the float estimate, $\check{\boldsymbol{N}}$ the integer-fixed solution.

Float extraction and rescaling to cycles. The filter state stores per-band ambiguity states in *metres* ($\lambda_s N$, one per tracked (satellite, signal)), not cycles, so the resolver first forms the between-satellite-differenced float and covariance by explicit differencing against the pivot p_g and then rescales by wavelength. (In baseline mode the state already holds the double difference and the differencing step below collapses to a direct selection; see Section 8.6.) For a differenced pair k with satellite index $i(k)$ and pivot index $p(k)$ (`src/core/filter/AmbiguityResolver.cpp`):

$$y_k^{\nabla\Delta} = \boldsymbol{x}_{\,i(k)} - \boldsymbol{x}_{\,p(k)}, \qquad \text{(DD float, m)} \tag{56}$$

$$\boldsymbol{Q}_{kl}^{\nabla\Delta} = \boldsymbol{P}_{i_k i_l} - \boldsymbol{P}_{i_k p_l} - \boldsymbol{P}_{p_k i_l} + \boldsymbol{P}_{p_k p_l}, \qquad \text{(DD covariance, m}^2\text{)} \tag{57}$$

$$\hat{\boldsymbol{N}}_k = y_k^{\nabla\Delta}/\lambda_k, \qquad (\boldsymbol{Q}_{\hat{N}})_{kl} = \boldsymbol{Q}_{kl}^{\nabla\Delta}/(\lambda_k\lambda_l). \qquad \text{(cycle domain)} \tag{58}$$

The rescaling (58) is load-bearing: running MLAMBDA on metre-domain floats would round toward integer-*metre* values with no carrier-cycle semantics, and the ratio test (Section 8.5) would degenerate to ≈ 1 irrespective of float quality. The per-pair wavelength λ_k is resolved with GLONASS FDMA per-satellite frequencies where applicable, and $\boldsymbol{Q}^{\nabla\Delta}$ is symmetrised, $\boldsymbol{Q}^{\nabla\Delta} \leftarrow \tfrac{1}{2}(\boldsymbol{Q}^{\nabla\Delta}+\boldsymbol{Q}^{\nabla\Delta\mathrm{T}})$, before factorisation. The DD pivot p_g is the highest-elevation satellite within each (constellation, signal) group, consistent with the BSSD pivot of Section 5; all remaining satellites in the group are differenced against it.

8.2 Decorrelation: LDL^{T} factorisation and the integer Z-transform

Factorisation. MLAMBDA factorises the symmetric positive-definite ambiguity covariance as

$$\boldsymbol{Q}_{\hat{N}} \;=\; \boldsymbol{L}^{\mathrm{T}}\,\boldsymbol{D}\,\boldsymbol{L}, \qquad \boldsymbol{L} \text{ unit lower-triangular}, \;\; \boldsymbol{D} = \mathrm{diag}(d_1,\ldots,d_n), \;\; d_i > 0, \tag{59}$$

factored in reverse index order (the Chang–Yang MLAMBDA convention). A non-positive pivot $d_i \le 0$ aborts the fix, since it signals a non-PD covariance. After reduction, d_i is the *conditional variance* of the i-th decorrelated ambiguity given the later ones; it feeds the success-rate gate of Section 8.5 directly.

The Z-transform. The central device of LAMBDA [12] is a unimodular integer transform $\boldsymbol{Z} \in \mathbb{Z}^{n\times n}$, $|\det \boldsymbol{Z}| = 1$, that re-parameterises

$$\boldsymbol{z} = \boldsymbol{Z}^{\mathrm{T}}\hat{\boldsymbol{N}}, \qquad \boldsymbol{Q}_{\hat{z}} = \boldsymbol{Z}^{\mathrm{T}}\,\boldsymbol{Q}_{\hat{N}}\,\boldsymbol{Z}, \tag{60}$$

so that the transformed ambiguities are nearly decorrelated (small off-diagonal $\boldsymbol{L}$ entries) and their conditional variances are ordered. Because $\boldsymbol{Z}$ is unimodular the integer minimiser maps back exactly, $\check{\boldsymbol{N}} = (\boldsymbol{Z}^{\mathrm{T}})^{-1}\check{\boldsymbol{z}}$ with $(\boldsymbol{Z}^{\mathrm{T}})^{-1}$ also integer; decorrelation therefore does not alter the solution of (55) — it only makes the search ellipsoid closer to spherical, collapsing the enumeration count by orders of magnitude. The reduction interleaves two operations sweeping $j = n-2$ downward.

Integer Gauss transformations zero the magnitude of sub-diagonal $\boldsymbol{L}$ entries by integer column operations,

$$\mu = \lceil L_{ij} \rfloor, \qquad \boldsymbol{L}_{(:,j)} \mathrel{-}= \mu\, \boldsymbol{L}_{(:,i)}, \qquad \boldsymbol{Z}_{(:,j)} \mathrel{-}= \mu\, \boldsymbol{Z}_{(:,i)}, \tag{61}$$

where $\lceil \cdot \rfloor$ is round-to-nearest, keeping every $|L_{ij}| \le \frac{1}{2}$.

Permutations (conditional adjacent swaps) reorder ambiguities when doing so reduces the later conditional variance. With $\bar{d}_j = d_j + L_{j+1,j}^2\, d_{j+1}$, the swap fires when

$$\bar{d}_j + \varepsilon \;<\; d_{j+1}, \qquad \varepsilon = 10^{-6}, \tag{62}$$

after which d_j, d_{j+1}, the affected rows/columns of $\boldsymbol{L}$ and the columns of $\boldsymbol{Z}$ are updated by the standard rank-one formulas ($\eta = d_j/\bar{d}_j$, $\lambda = d_{j+1}L_{j+1,j}/\bar{d}_j$, $d_j \leftarrow \eta\, d_{j+1}$, $d_{j+1} \leftarrow \bar{d}_j$), and the sweep restarts from $j = n-2$. The guard $\varepsilon = 10^{-6}$ prevents thrashing on near-equal variances and is a numerical safeguard, not an estimator knob; it has no config exposure.

The shrinking-ellipsoid search. The reduced problem is solved by depth-first enumeration of lattice points inside the ellipsoid $\sum_i (z_i - \hat{z}_i)^2/d_i \le \chi^2$, in Schnorr–Euchner order (nearest integer first, then zig-zagging outward). Recursing from the last level $k = n-1$ down to 0,

$$\hat{z}_k = \hat{\boldsymbol{N}}_k + \sum_{i>k} (z_i - \hat{z}_i)\, L_{ik}, \qquad \text{(conditional centre)} \tag{63}$$

$$z_k = \lceil \hat{z}_k \rfloor, \qquad \mathrm{dist}_k = \mathrm{dist}_{k+1} + \frac{(\hat{z}_k - z_k)^2}{d_k}. \qquad \text{(partial distance)} \tag{64}$$

When a complete integer vector reaches level 0 with cumulative distance below the current bound χ^2, it is recorded and the bound shrinks to the worst retained candidate, contracting the ellipsoid as better candidates are found. The search retains the $m = 2$ best candidates (for the ratio test) sorted by ascending squared distance, under a hard iteration cap (`kMaxIter` = 10 000). Its outputs are the two smallest objective values $s_1 \le s_2$ of (55) and the best integer vector $\check{\boldsymbol{z}}$, back-transformed via $\check{\boldsymbol{N}} = (\boldsymbol{Z}^{\mathrm{T}})^{-1}\check{\boldsymbol{z}}$.

8.3 Wide-lane / narrow-lane decomposition (PPP path)

Standard PPP and PPP-RTK AR use a *wide-lane-first* decomposition when Melbourne–Wübbena (MW)-resolved wide-lane (WL) integers are available, halving the search dimension and exploiting the long WL wavelength [5]. The driver attempts the WL-constrained narrow-lane (NL) fix before any unconstrained LAMBDA and — critically — does *not* fall through to an unconstrained search when WL information exists but the constrained fix fails: a wrong-WL fix is worse than no fix, so "no NL AR for satellites whose WL is float" is the enforced hierarchy (`src/core/filter/AmbiguityResolver.cpp`).

WL from Melbourne–Wübbena (integer by contract). The DD wide-lane integer is differenced directly from the MW detector's single-difference WL integers (`src/core/slip/MwSlipDetector`), not searched:

$$\nabla\Delta N_{\mathrm{WL}} = N_{\mathrm{WL}}^{i} - N_{\mathrm{WL}}^{p_g} \in \mathbb{Z}, \qquad \lambda_{\mathrm{WL}} = \frac{c}{f_1 - f_2}. \tag{65}$$

NL search variable. For each dual-frequency DD pair the float narrow-lane ambiguity (ionosphere-free phase combination, in NL cycles) is formed by the transform $\boldsymbol{T}$,

$$\hat{n}_{\mathrm{NL}} = \frac{f_1\,\nabla\Delta N_1 + f_2\,\nabla\Delta N_2}{f_1+f_2} = \frac{1}{f_1+f_2}\left(\frac{f_1}{\lambda_1}\,\nabla\Delta_1 + \frac{f_2}{\lambda_2}\,\nabla\Delta_2\right), \qquad \lambda_{\mathrm{NL}} = \frac{c}{f_1+f_2}, \tag{66}$$

with reduced covariance $\boldsymbol{Q}_{\mathrm{NL}} = \boldsymbol{T}\,\boldsymbol{Q}^{\nabla\Delta}\,\boldsymbol{T}^{\mathrm{T}}$. Only NL-paired DDs enter LAMBDA; unpaired single-signal DDs are excluded so they cannot contaminate the ratio test.

Integer-recentring shift. The float $\hat{n}_{\mathrm{NL}}$ is *not* integer-valued in general: substituting $N_2 = N_1 - \mathrm{WL}$ gives $\hat{n}_{\mathrm{NL}} = N_1 - \frac{f_2}{f_1+f_2}\,\mathrm{WL}$, which for GPS L1/L2 with $\mathrm{WL} = 1$ sits at $N_1 - 0.4379$ — neither integer is meaningfully closer and the ratio test degenerates near 1.6 regardless of float quality. The resolver therefore adds the known-WL offset so the search variable is integer in expectation,

$$\tilde{n}_k = \hat{n}_{\mathrm{NL},k} + \frac{f_2}{f_1+f_2}\,\nabla\Delta N_{\mathrm{WL},k} \;\approx\; N_{1,k} \;\in\; \mathbb{Z} + \text{noise}, \tag{67}$$

runs MLAMBDA on $\tilde{\boldsymbol{n}}$ (a constant per-row shift leaves $\boldsymbol{Q}_{\mathrm{NL}}$ unchanged), then back-shifts $\check{n}_{\mathrm{NL}} = \check{N}_1 - \frac{f_2}{f_1+f_2}\,\mathrm{WL}$.

Back-transform to per-signal DDs. The fixed integers map back to the two original signal DDs in metres,

$$\nabla\Delta_1^{\mathrm{fix}} = \left(\check{n}_{\mathrm{NL}} + \tfrac{f_2}{f_1+f_2}\,\nabla\Delta N_{\mathrm{WL}}\right)\lambda_1, \qquad \nabla\Delta_2^{\mathrm{fix}} = \left(\check{n}_{\mathrm{NL}} - \tfrac{f_1}{f_1+f_2}\,\nabla\Delta N_{\mathrm{WL}}\right)\lambda_2, \tag{68}$$

which re-enter the filter through the constrained update of Section 8.6.

State-basis variants. When `estimation.state_ambiguity_basis` = `nl_wl` the state holds NL/WL ambiguities directly and there are no per-band DD pairs to enumerate; today only the MW-resolved WL integers are applied as constraint rows (a full NL LAMBDA search with WL pre-constrained is future work in this basis). The complementary WL-only mode (`estimation.ambiguity_resolution.wl_only`, in the `per_band` basis) applies the cycle-domain constraint $\nabla\Delta_1/\lambda_1 - \nabla\Delta_2/\lambda_2 = \nabla\Delta N_{\mathrm{WL}}$ as a single pseudo-observation per pair without any NL search, with covariance inflation on the affected single-difference states when MW re-locks at a new integer so the state snaps within one epoch. A cross-frequency parity check rejects all WL DDs of a triple-frequency satellite when the telescoping cycle-count consistency $\nabla\Delta_{ab} - \nabla\Delta_{ac} + \nabla\Delta_{bc} \neq 0$ fails.

8.4 Partial / subset ambiguity resolution

There is no LAMBDA-internal partial search; subset selection happens *upstream* by candidate gating when the DD pairs are built (`src/core/filter/AmbiguityResolver.cpp`). A satellite/signal ambiguity is admitted to the integer set only if it passes every filter:

- **Initialised** — the state entry is non-zero (seeded by data), and **non-frozen** — its variance is non-zero (excludes a BSSD-frozen pivot).
- **Elevation** — $\theta_r^i \geq \theta_{\mathrm{AR}}$ (`elevation_mask`).
- **Resolvable** — the satellite is not flagged unresolvable for want of bias/ATX (BIA, ATX) coverage.
- **Constellation** — $g(i) \in$ `active_systems`, when that list is non-empty.

- **Pairable** — the (constellation, signal) group holds ≥ 2 satellites, so a pivot difference exists.

The constellation filter keeps a system in the *float* solution while excluding it from the candidate set — useful when one constellation's residual model bias would drag down the ratio test. Together these realise a static partial-AR: the search runs only over the high-confidence subset, and acceptance (Section 8.5) is all-or-nothing on that subset.

8.5 Validation: ratio test and fixed-failure-rate gate

A fix is committed only if it passes all three of the following gates (a logical AND). The ratio and fixed-failure-rate (FFR) gates are theoretically distinct: one bounds the discrimination between the two best candidates, the other bounds the absolute success probability.

Ratio test (discrimination).

$$\boxed{\text{ratio} = \frac{s_2}{s_1} \;\geq\; \tau_{\text{ratio}}, \qquad s_1 \leq s_2 \text{ the two smallest ILS objectives,}} \tag{69}$$

with s_1, s_2 from the search of Section 8.2 and threshold τ_{ratio} (`ratio_threshold`). A second upper-bound rejection ratio $> \tau_{\text{ratio}}^{\max}$ (`ratio_upper_bound`) catches the pathological case of a degenerate covariance direction — a near-zero s_1 left by a previous wrong-integer hold — that would otherwise produce ultra-confident but meaningless ratios.

Fixed-failure-rate gate (bootstrap success rate). A geometry-driven, self-tuning lower bound on the ILS success probability,

$$\boxed{P_{s,\text{boot}} = \prod_{i=1}^{n} \operatorname{erf}\!\left(\frac{1}{2\sqrt{2\,d_i}}\right) \;\geq\; P_s^{\min},} \tag{70}$$

where the d_i are the post-reduction LDL^{T} conditional variances of (59) and $P_s^{\min}$ is `min_success_rate`. Per dimension the factor is $\Pr\big(|\mathcal{N}(0, d_i)| < \tfrac{1}{2}\big)$ — the probability that sequential bootstrapped rounding lands on the correct integer — and the product is the standard Teunissen lower bound on the true ILS success rate. This ties the acceptance threshold to the actual problem geometry rather than to a fixed ratio alone.

Per-pair residual backstop. The joint ratio test can pass on a borderline set in which one pair sits near a half-cycle boundary; the fix is rejected if any single DD's fractional residual exceeds a cap,

$$\max_k \big|\hat{\boldsymbol{N}}_k - \check{\boldsymbol{N}}_k\big| \;\leq\; \kappa_{\text{frac}} \quad \text{(cycles)}, \tag{71}$$

with $\kappa_{\text{frac}} =$ `nl_max_per_pair_frac`.

Convergence guards. Before any search the resolver short-circuits AR while the float is immature — if the epoch count is below `min_epochs` or the position standard deviation $\sqrt{\boldsymbol{P}_{00} + \boldsymbol{P}_{11} + \boldsymbol{P}_{22}}$ exceeds `max_position_sigma_m` — because a marginal fix accepted before the covariance settles can lock onto wrong integers and then poison every subsequent epoch.

8.6 Feedback: constrained pseudo-observation update

Accepted integers are *not* fed back by the classical perfect back-substitution (the $R = 0$ conditioning form)

$$\boldsymbol{x}_{\text{fix}} = \boldsymbol{x} - \boldsymbol{Q}_{\boldsymbol{aa}}\, \boldsymbol{Q}^{\nabla\Delta-1}\big(y^{\nabla\Delta} - \check{\boldsymbol{N}}\big), \qquad \boldsymbol{P}_{\text{fix}} = \boldsymbol{P} - \boldsymbol{Q}_{\boldsymbol{aa}}\, \boldsymbol{Q}^{\nabla\Delta-1}\boldsymbol{Q}_{\boldsymbol{aa}}^{\mathrm{T}}, \tag{72}$$

but via a *finite-variance Joseph-form pseudo-observation* (`src/core/filter/AmbiguityResolver.cpp`; kernel `KalmanFilter::josephPseudoUpdate` in `include/filter/KalmanFilter.hpp`). The reason is structural: (72) drives the fixed ambiguity rows of $\boldsymbol{P}$ to ≈ 0 variance, so the next epoch's LAMBDA sees a near-singular $\boldsymbol{Q}^{\nabla\Delta}$ and emits meaningless inflated ratios that trip the upper-bound guard of (69) indefinitely. A finite-variance pseudo-observation instead keeps $\boldsymbol{P}$ well-conditioned and lets subsequent epochs re-confirm the integer (asymptoting toward it) or detect a slip through its residual.

For each accepted DD pair k the constraint row, innovation and noise are

$$\boxed{\boldsymbol{H}_{(k,\,i)} = +1, \quad \boldsymbol{H}_{(k,\,p)} = -1, \qquad v_k = \check{\boldsymbol{N}}_k - \big(\boldsymbol{x}_i - \boldsymbol{x}_p\big), \qquad \boldsymbol{R} = \sigma^2_{\text{hold}}\, \boldsymbol{I},} \tag{73}$$

followed by $(\boldsymbol{x}_{\text{fix}}, \boldsymbol{P}_{\text{fix}}) = \textsc{JosephUpdate}(\boldsymbol{x}, \boldsymbol{P}, \boldsymbol{H}, \boldsymbol{v}, \boldsymbol{R})$, with $\sigma^2_{\text{hold}} =$ `hold_variance`. The DD/baseline path uses a single-column selector $\boldsymbol{H}_{(k,\,\text{idx})} = +1$ since the corresponding state value already *is* the double difference. Fix-and-hold mode (`estimation.ambiguity_resolution.mode` = 3) re-applies the same constraint each epoch to suppress float drift. This pseudo-observation feedback is the resolution of the mode-3 destabilisation that the earlier $R = 0$ form (72) induced; (72) survives in the code only as the documented, rejected legacy approach.

8.7 Configuration summary

All tunable thresholds live under the JSON path `estimation.ambiguity_resolution.*`, parsed in `src/core/config/GnssConfigLoad.cpp` with defaults in `include/filter/AmbiguityResolver.hpp`. The invariant estimator theory of Sections 8.1 to 8.6 carries no knobs — changing it changes the mathematics, not a policy.

Symbol	Config key (`...ambiguity_resolution.`)	Default	Role
—	`mode`	`0`	0 float / 1 continuous / 2 instantaneous / 3 fix-and-hold
τ_{ratio}	`ratio_threshold`	`3.0`	ratio-test acceptance (69)
$\tau^{\max}_{\text{ratio}}$	`ratio_upper_bound`	`1e4`	degenerate-covariance reject (69)
$P_s^{\min}$	`min_success_rate`	`0.999`	FFR gate (70)
κ_{frac}	`nl_max_per_pair_frac`	`0.15`	per-pair residual cap (71)
θ_{AR}	`elevation_mask`	`20°`	candidate elevation mask
σ^2_{hold}	`hold_variance`	`0.001` m^2	pseudo-obs $\boldsymbol{R}$ (73)
$n^{\text{ep}}_{\min}$	`min_epochs`	`10`	convergence guard
$\sigma^{\max}_{\text{pos}}$	`max_position_sigma_m`	`0.05` m	convergence guard
—	`wl_only`	`false`	MW-WL-only, no NL search
—	`active_systems`	`[]` (all)	constellation subset (Section 8.4)
—	`state_ambiguity_basis` [†]	`per_band`	`per_band` vs `nl_wl` dispatch

[†] Path is `estimation.state_ambiguity_basis` — one level above the `ambiguity_resolution` block.

9 Inertial aiding

When an IMU is configured (`imu.enabled`; the sibling boolean `estimation.aiding.imu` is the future `AidingSourceManager` selector and is presently inert), the inter-epoch time update of Section 6.1 is replaced by a first-order strapdown mechanization in the Earth-centred Earth-fixed (ECEF) frame. The mechanization is implemented in `src/core/filter/ImuIntegrator.cpp` and spliced into the filter covariance by `KalmanFilter::predictAided` (`src/core/filter/KalmanFilter.cpp`); the live predict path routes through `Application::run` → `AidingSourceManager` → `src/core/aiding/ImuAidingSource.cp`

The formulation is an *error-state* extended Kalman filter. The mechanization propagates the nominal navigation state $(\boldsymbol{r}, \boldsymbol{v}, \boldsymbol{C}_b^e)$ deterministically from the inertial samples, while a 15-element INS error vector

$$\delta\boldsymbol{x}_{\text{ins}} = \begin{bmatrix} \delta\boldsymbol{r} & \delta\boldsymbol{v} & \delta\boldsymbol{\psi} & \delta\boldsymbol{b}_a & \delta\boldsymbol{b}_g \end{bmatrix}^{\mathrm{T}} \in \mathbb{R}^{15} \tag{74}$$

carries the linearised transition and process noise that drive the covariance. Three attitude-error states $\delta\boldsymbol{\psi}$, three accelerometer-bias states $\boldsymbol{b}_a$, and three gyro-bias states $\boldsymbol{b}_g$ augment the existing position state (and, when `estimation.estimate_velocity` is set, the three velocity states); the augmented block is allocated contiguously by `StateManager` (accessors `getAttitudeIndex`, `getAccelBiasIndex`, `getGyroBiasIndex`).

Remark 1 (Implemented scope). The block order of Equation (74) ($[\delta\boldsymbol{r}, \delta\boldsymbol{v}, \delta\boldsymbol{\psi}, \delta\boldsymbol{b}_a, \delta\boldsymbol{b}_g]$) is fixed by `ImuIntegrator`. *No* lever-arm state and *no* sensor scale-factor states are carried, and there is no IMU-to-antenna lever-arm term in the GNSS measurement model (Section 9.4). These are roadmap items, not part of the current implementation; the corresponding terms are omitted from every equation below rather than written and then ignored.

9.1 Strapdown mechanization

For each IMU sample the raw specific force $\tilde{\boldsymbol{a}}$ and angular rate $\tilde{\boldsymbol{\omega}}$ (both in the body frame) are bias-corrected with the current filter estimates,

$$\boldsymbol{f}_b = \tilde{\boldsymbol{a}} - \boldsymbol{b}_a, \qquad \boldsymbol{\omega}_b = \tilde{\boldsymbol{\omega}} - \boldsymbol{b}_g, \tag{75}$$

and integrated over the sample interval Δt. The attitude direction-cosine matrix $\boldsymbol{C}_b^e$ (body → ECEF) is updated to first order with Earth-rotation compensation,

$$\boxed{\boldsymbol{C}_b^e \;\leftarrow\; \boldsymbol{C}_b^e\big(\boldsymbol{I} + [\boldsymbol{\omega}_b]_\times\,\Delta t\big) \;-\; [\boldsymbol{\omega}_{ie}^e]_\times\,\boldsymbol{C}_b^e\,\Delta t,} \tag{76}$$

where $\boldsymbol{\omega}_{ie}^e = [\,0,\,0,\,\omega_e\,]^{\mathrm{T}}$ is the ECEF Earth-rotation vector ($\omega_e = 7.292\,115\,146\,7 \times 10^{-5}\,\mathrm{rad\,s^{-1}}$, `common/Constants.hpp`) and $[\cdot]_\times$ is the skew-symmetric (cross-product) matrix. To curb numerical drift, $\boldsymbol{C}_b^e$ is re-orthonormalised by singular-value decomposition every 100 samples. The velocity and position propagate as

$$\boxed{\begin{aligned} \boldsymbol{v}_{k+1} &= \boldsymbol{v}_k + \big(\boldsymbol{C}_b^e\,\boldsymbol{f}_b + \boldsymbol{g}^e(\boldsymbol{r}_k) - 2\,[\boldsymbol{\omega}_{ie}^e]_\times\,\boldsymbol{v}_k\big)\Delta t, && (77)\\ \boldsymbol{r}_{k+1} &= \boldsymbol{r}_k + \tfrac{1}{2}\big(\boldsymbol{v}_k + \boldsymbol{v}_{k+1}\big)\Delta t. && (78) \end{aligned}}$$

Equation (77) applies the Coriolis acceleration $-2\,[\boldsymbol{\omega}_{ie}^e]_\times\boldsymbol{v}$, while the centrifugal acceleration is folded into the gravity vector $\boldsymbol{g}^e$ (i.e. $\boldsymbol{g}^e$ is a *plumb-bob* gravity, gravitational plus centrifugal); Equation (78) uses a trapezoidal position update.

The gravity vector is a point-mass radial model plus the centrifugal term (`ImuIntegrator::computeGravityEcef`

$$\boldsymbol{g}^e(\boldsymbol{r}) = -\,\frac{\mu}{\|\boldsymbol{r}\|^3}\,\boldsymbol{r} \;+\; \omega_e^2\,[\,p_x,\,p_y,\,0\,]^{\mathrm{T}}, \qquad \mu = 3.986\,005 \times 10^{14}\,\mathrm{m^3\,s^{-2}}. \tag{79}$$

The normal-gravity (Somigliana) flattening and the J_2 zonal term are *not* modelled; over a single GNSS epoch interval the resulting deterministic acceleration error is small and is absorbed by the estimated accelerometer bias $\boldsymbol{b}_a$.

9.2 INS error-state dynamics

Linearising Equations (76) to (78) about the nominal trajectory yields the continuous error dynamics $\dot{\delta\boldsymbol{x}}_{\text{ins}} = \boldsymbol{F}_{\text{ins}}\,\delta\boldsymbol{x}_{\text{ins}} + \boldsymbol{G}_{\text{ins}}\,\boldsymbol{w}$, with, in the block order of Equation (74),

$$\boldsymbol{F}_{\text{ins}} = \begin{bmatrix} \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{I} & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} \\ \boldsymbol{0} & -2[\boldsymbol{\omega}^e_{ie}]_\times & -[\boldsymbol{f}^e]_\times & \boldsymbol{C}^e_b & \boldsymbol{0} \\ \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} & -[\boldsymbol{\omega}^e_{ie}]_\times & \boldsymbol{0} & -\boldsymbol{C}^e_b \\ \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} \\ \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} \end{bmatrix}, \qquad \boldsymbol{f}^e := \boldsymbol{C}^e_b\,\boldsymbol{f}_b. \tag{80}$$

Both sensor biases are modelled as pure random walks (zero deterministic dynamics, the null bottom rows of Equation (80)). Two terms of the textbook ECEF error model are deliberately dropped: the position-error feedback row ($[\boldsymbol{F}_{\text{ins}}]_{\delta\boldsymbol{r},\delta\boldsymbol{r}} = -[\boldsymbol{\omega}^e_{ie}]_\times$) and the gravity-gradient coupling $[\boldsymbol{F}_{\text{ins}}]_{\delta\boldsymbol{v},\delta\boldsymbol{r}} = -\,\partial\boldsymbol{g}^e/\partial\boldsymbol{r} - [\boldsymbol{\omega}^e_{ie}]^2_\times$. This is a first-order approximation that is accurate over the short epoch interval of a GNSS-aided run. The discrete transition is taken to first order,

$$[\boldsymbol{\Phi}_{\text{ins}}]_k = \boldsymbol{I} + \boldsymbol{F}_{\text{ins}}\,\Delta t. \tag{81}$$

The process noise maps the continuous accelerometer / gyro white noise and the bias random walks through

$$[\boldsymbol{Q}_{\text{ins}}]_k = \boldsymbol{G}_{\text{ins}}\,\boldsymbol{W}\,\boldsymbol{G}^{\mathrm{T}}_{\text{ins}}\,\Delta t, \quad \boldsymbol{G}_{\text{ins}} = \begin{bmatrix} \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} \\ \boldsymbol{C}^e_b & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} \\ \boldsymbol{0} & -\boldsymbol{C}^e_b & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} \\ \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{I} & \boldsymbol{0} \\ \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{I} \end{bmatrix}, \quad \boldsymbol{W} = \operatorname{diag}\!\left(\sigma_a^2, \sigma_g^2, \sigma_{ba}^2, \sigma_{bg}^2\right) \otimes \boldsymbol{I}_3, \tag{82}$$

with the spectral densities $\sigma_a, \sigma_g, \sigma_{ba}, \sigma_{bg}$ read from `imu.{accel_noise_density, gyro_noise_density, accel_bias_instability, gyro_bias_instability}` (defaults in `config/GnssConfigTypes.hpp`). Over one GNSS epoch the per-sample $([\boldsymbol{\Phi}_{\text{ins}}]_k, [\boldsymbol{Q}_{\text{ins}}]_k)$ accumulate by the standard recursion

$$\boldsymbol{\Phi}_{\text{ins}} \leftarrow [\boldsymbol{\Phi}_{\text{ins}}]_k\,\boldsymbol{\Phi}_{\text{ins}}, \qquad \boldsymbol{Q}_{\text{ins}} \leftarrow [\boldsymbol{\Phi}_{\text{ins}}]_k\,\boldsymbol{Q}_{\text{ins}}\,[\boldsymbol{\Phi}_{\text{ins}}]^{\mathrm{T}}_k + [\boldsymbol{Q}_{\text{ins}}]_k. \tag{83}$$

9.3 Covariance splice and attitude feedback

The accumulated 15×15 pair $(\boldsymbol{\Phi}_{\text{ins}}, \boldsymbol{Q}_{\text{ins}})$ is spliced (*assigned*, not accumulated) onto an identity-seeded full-state transition $\boldsymbol{F}$ and onto the random-walk process-noise baseline $\boldsymbol{Q}$ over the indices the INS owns; the non-INS states (clock, troposphere, ionosphere, ambiguities, ...) retain their standard random-walk model from Section 6.1. The covariance is then propagated once and symmetrised,

$$\boxed{\boldsymbol{P} \leftarrow \boldsymbol{F}\,\boldsymbol{P}\,\boldsymbol{F}^{\mathrm{T}} + \boldsymbol{Q}, \qquad \boldsymbol{P} \leftarrow \tfrac{1}{2}\left(\boldsymbol{P} + \boldsymbol{P}^{\mathrm{T}}\right).} \tag{84}$$

The nominal navigation states $(\boldsymbol{r}, \boldsymbol{v})$ are overwritten by the mechanised values of Equations (77) to (78), and the attitude error is reset, $\delta\boldsymbol{\psi} := \boldsymbol{0}$, because the rotation increment has already been

applied directly to $\boldsymbol{C}_b^e$ in Equation (76). After the subsequent GNSS measurement update the corrected attitude error feeds back multiplicatively into the DCM and is again reset,

$$\boldsymbol{C}_b^e \leftarrow \left(\boldsymbol{I} - [\delta\boldsymbol{\psi}]_\times\right)\boldsymbol{C}_b^e, \qquad \delta\boldsymbol{\psi} := \mathbf{0}, \tag{85}$$

followed by SVD re-orthonormalisation (`KalmanFilter::update`). This closed-loop reset keeps $\delta\boldsymbol{\psi}$ a small-angle quantity throughout, so the linearisation in Equation (80) stays valid.

9.4 Coupling modes and the GNSS update

How the GNSS observations correct the inertial errors depends on the coupling mode (`imu.coupling_mode`).

Loosely coupled (default). The GNSS code and carrier-phase Jacobians of Section 4.3 touch only the position (and velocity) columns. The INS error states $\delta\boldsymbol{\psi}, \boldsymbol{b}_a, \boldsymbol{b}_g$ therefore receive *no direct* observation partials; they are corrected only indirectly, through the off-diagonal cross-covariances that Equation (84) builds between the position/velocity block and the attitude/bias block. The attitude correction is then realised by the feedback of Equation (85).

Tightly coupled. In the tightly-coupled mode the *Doppler* observation alone gains direct attitude and accelerometer-bias columns (`src/core/measurement/MeasurementModel.cpp`). With $\boldsymbol{f}^e = \boldsymbol{C}_b^e \boldsymbol{f}_b$ the specific force in ECEF and $\boldsymbol{e}_r^i$ the unit line-of-sight of Equation (7), the Doppler measurement function h_D contributes

$$\boxed{\frac{\partial h_\mathrm{D}}{\partial \delta\boldsymbol{\psi}} = -\left[\boldsymbol{f}^e\right]_\times^\mathrm{T} \boldsymbol{e}_r^i, \qquad \frac{\partial h_\mathrm{D}}{\partial \boldsymbol{b}_a} = -\left(\boldsymbol{C}_b^e\right)^\mathrm{T} \boldsymbol{e}_r^i.} \tag{86}$$

The specific force fed into Equation (86) is a static-rest approximation $\boldsymbol{f}_b \approx (\boldsymbol{C}_b^e)^\mathrm{T}(-\boldsymbol{g}^e) - \boldsymbol{b}_a$ (`ImuAidingSource.cpp`); it is exact only when the platform's true acceleration is negligible against gravity. The *code and carrier-phase rows carry no attitude or bias partials in either mode* — only Doppler couples directly to the inertial errors.

Remark 2 (Relinearisation under tight coupling). The tightly-coupled path retains the legacy single *naive* second-pass relinearisation rather than the prior-anchored iterated EKF of Section 6.3: re-deriving the gain from a fixed prior conflicts with the multiplicative attitude/bias feedback of Equation (85), which has already mutated $\boldsymbol{C}_b^e$ between passes.

10 Real-time SSR corrections

The real-time engine consumes network corrections in *State Space Representation* (SSR): per-satellite, per-signal refinements to the broadcast orbit, clock, and hardware biases, streamed as RTCM 3.x messages (legacy 1057–1068 / 1240–1270) or as their IGS-SSR `4076` repackaging [3, 8]. Each SSR quantity refines *exactly one* term already present in Equations (4) and (5); none introduces a new state. This is what separates the precise real-time mode from broadcast-only operation: with SSR applied, $c\,\mathrm{d}t^i$ and $\boldsymbol{r}^i$ are centimetre-grade and the satellite biases B_s^i, b_s^i are *known* rather than absorbed into the ambiguity.

Decoded records are cached per satellite in the singleton `products/SsrCorrectionStore`; the consumers (`model/ModelGeometry`, `corrections/GnssCorrections`, `measurement/MeasurementModel`) query the store and fall through to broadcast-only when it is empty, so every equation below collapses to Equations (4) and (5) in post-processing. The streaming and decoding plumbing — RTCM frame

parse, the per-satellite mutex-guarded cache, the real-time push loop — is deliberately separated from this invariant correction math; see the code pointer in Section 10.6. There is no `enable_ssr` flag: SSR application is implicit and store-driven.

10.1 Orbit correction — refines ρ_r^i

The orbit message carries a delta in the satellite's radial / along-track / cross-track (RAC) frame, anchored to the broadcast ephemeris of issue IODE. The frame is built from the broadcast position $\boldsymbol{r}^i_{\text{brdc}}$ and velocity $\dot{\boldsymbol{r}}^i_{\text{brdc}}$ (`products/SsrCorrectionStore.cpp`):

$$\hat{\boldsymbol{e}}_a = \frac{\dot{\boldsymbol{r}}^i_{\text{brdc}}}{\|\dot{\boldsymbol{r}}^i_{\text{brdc}}\|}, \quad \hat{\boldsymbol{e}}_c = \frac{\boldsymbol{r}^i_{\text{brdc}} \times \dot{\boldsymbol{r}}^i_{\text{brdc}}}{\|\boldsymbol{r}^i_{\text{brdc}} \times \dot{\boldsymbol{r}}^i_{\text{brdc}}\|}, \quad \hat{\boldsymbol{e}}_r = \hat{\boldsymbol{e}}_a \times \hat{\boldsymbol{e}}_c. \tag{87}$$

The RAC delta is propagated to the query epoch with its rate term and rotated into ECEF. With $\delta t = t - t_{\text{SSR}}$ the age of the correction, $\boldsymbol{\delta}_{\text{rac}} = (\delta_r, \delta_a, \delta_c)^{\text{T}}$ its components and $\dot{\boldsymbol{\delta}}_{\text{rac}}$ their rate,

$$\boxed{\boldsymbol{r}^i \;=\; \boldsymbol{r}^i_{\text{brdc}} \;-\; \big[\,\hat{\boldsymbol{e}}_r \;\; \hat{\boldsymbol{e}}_a \;\; \hat{\boldsymbol{e}}_c\,\big]\big(\boldsymbol{\delta}_{\text{rac}} + \dot{\boldsymbol{\delta}}_{\text{rac}}\,\delta t\big).} \tag{88}$$

The *subtraction* follows the RTCM sign convention $\boldsymbol{\delta}$ = broadcast−precise (`products/SsrCorrectionStore.cpp`). The corrected $\boldsymbol{r}^i$ then enters $\rho_r^i = \|\boldsymbol{r}^i - \boldsymbol{r}_r\|$ and the line-of-sight $\boldsymbol{e}^i_{\hat{r}}$ of Equation (7) unchanged: the orbit correction never touches an observation equation directly, only the geometry (Section 4.3) that feeds it. Because the clock is queried against the same broadcast ephemeris, the broadcast clock's *radial* component cancels consistently against Equation (90). The decoded RAC scale factors are fixed by RTCM 10403.3 (radial δ_r a 22-bit two's-complement field at 0.1 mm, along/cross at 0.4 mm, rates at 1 and 4 μm/s respectively; `rtcm/RtcmSsrDecoder.cpp`).

10.2 Clock correction — refines $-c\,\mathrm{d}t^i$

The clock message carries a quadratic polynomial in time-from-epoch, optionally augmented by a high-rate additive delta δC_{hr}. The total satellite-clock correction, in metres, is

$$\Delta C^i(t) \;=\; C_0 + C_1\,\delta t + C_2\,\delta t^2 + \delta C_{\text{hr}}, \qquad \delta t = t - t_{\text{SSR}}, \tag{89}$$

converted to seconds and *added* to the baseline clock (`products/SsrCorrectionStore.cpp`):

$$\boxed{c\,\mathrm{d}t^i \;=\; c\,\mathrm{d}t^i_{\text{base}} \;+\; \Delta C^i(t),} \tag{90}$$

where $\mathrm{d}t^i_{\text{base}}$ is the precise CLK sample (post-processing) or the broadcast clock polynomial (live rooftop mode, `products/LiveEphemerisStore`). This term enters Equations (4) and (5) through $-c\,\mathrm{d}t^i$, identically on code and phase. The high-rate clock is additive *on top of* the polynomial, not a replacement (`corrections/GnssCorrections.cpp`); the C_2 field is a 27-bit two's-complement quantity at $2 \times 10^{-8}\,\mathrm{m/s^2}$.

10.3 IOD gate at correction-set boundaries

Orbit and clock corrections are deltas against a *specific* broadcast ephemeris, so they are applied only when the SSR record's IODE matches that of the broadcast ephemeris from which the baseline orbit/clock was evaluated:

$$\text{apply} \iff \big(\text{IODE}_{\text{brdc}} < 0\big) \;\vee\; \big(\text{IODE}_{\text{SSR}} < 0\big) \;\vee\; \big(\text{IODE}_{\text{brdc}} = \text{IODE}_{\text{SSR}}\big), \tag{91}$$

the gate being permissive when either side is unknown (`SsrCorrectionStore::iodeMatches`, `products/SsrCorrectionStore.hpp`). A combined orbit+clock record (RTCM 1060/1066, IGS-SSR sub-type 3) is preferred over separate messages because it guarantees a single shared IODE (`products/SsrCorrectionStore.cpp`). At a correction-set boundary — the provider issuing a new ephemeris reference, hence a new IODE — the gate (91) simply declines the mismatched record until the matching broadcast ephemeris is in hand, avoiding a discontinuous jump in $\boldsymbol{r}^i$ or $c\,\mathrm{d}t^i$. Records older than `max_age_s` (default 60 s, the IGS-RTS update interval) are treated as absent.

10.4 Satellite biases — refine $-B_s^i$ and $-b_s^i$

SSR delivers *observable-specific biases* (OSB): one value per (satellite, RINEX-3 signal) pair, in metres. They are applied as a *known* additive correction to the modelled observable, with no state and no Jacobian row (`measurement/MeasurementModel.cpp`). The code OSB refines B_s^i in Equation (4):

$$\boxed{P_{r,s}^i = \rho_r^i + c(\mathrm{d}t_r - \mathrm{d}t^i) + c\,\delta t_r^{(g)} + T_r^i + \mu_s I_{r,1}^i + B_{r,s} \underbrace{- B_s^i}_{\text{SSR OSB}} + \varepsilon^P,} \tag{92}$$

and the phase OSB refines b_s^i in Equation (5):

$$\boxed{\Phi_{r,s}^i = \rho_r^i + c(\mathrm{d}t_r - \mathrm{d}t^i) + c\,\delta t_r^{(g)} + T_r^i - \mu_s I_{r,1}^i + \lambda_s N_{r,s}^i + b_{r,s} \underbrace{- b_s^i}_{\text{SSR OSB}} + \varepsilon^\Phi.} \tag{93}$$

The bias decoded from the stream is the satellite bias *present in* the observation, so it is removed from the clean model prediction with a $+1$ sign convention (`kSsrCodeBiasSign` = `kSsrPhaseBiasSign` = $+1$, `measurement/MeasurementModel.cpp`); the predicted observable accumulates it as `ssr_bias_term` (`MeasurementModel.cpp`). Biases are queried per *raw* signal only — an ionosphere-free composite key such as `C1W_C5X` returns zero and is skipped, consistent with the uncombined parameterisation of Equations (4) and (5). The code OSB is a 14-bit field at 0.01 m, the phase OSB a 20-bit field at 0.1 mm (`rtcm/RtcmSsrDecoder.cpp`).

Integer recoverability via consistent phase biases. Removing b_s^i is precisely what restores the integer property of $N_{r,s}^i$ promised in remark 1 of Equation (5). Once the satellite phase bias is known, the residual non-integer part of the ambiguity is the receiver phase bias $b_{r,s}$ *alone*, which cancels under between-satellite single differencing $\Delta\,\cdot$ (Section 5), leaving an integer single-difference ambiguity admissible to AR. This is the operational content of a *consistent* phase-bias product: the provider must generate b_s^i on the same network datum whose integer property the rover then exploits. The phase-bias message therefore carries three AR-critical metadata fields per signal (`rtcm/RtcmTypes.hpp`): an integer-preservation indicator, a two-bit wide-lane integer indicator, and a four-bit *discontinuity counter*.

Discontinuity handling. An incremented discontinuity counter signals that the provider's phase bias jumped between correction sets, breaking the integer connection of that arc. The engine treats this as an ambiguity-arc boundary: the affected $N_{r,s}^i$ is reset before the Kalman update (`realtime/RealTimeEngine.cpp`, via `StateManager::noteSsrDiscontinuity`), so the post-jump phase is re-initialised rather than fixed against a stale integer offset. This is the phase-bias analogue of the orbit/clock IOD gate (91): both protect state continuity across correction-set boundaries, one by declining a mismatched delta, the other by resetting the dependent ambiguity.

10.5 Ionosphere — $\mu_s I^i_{r,1}$ is not SSR-fed

For completeness, and to forestall a natural misreading of the term: although the SSR standard defines a global VTEC spherical-harmonic message (IGS-SSR IM = 201) and regional STEC products, *neither is decoded by this engine*. The IGS-SSR classifier rejects IM = 201 as unsupported (`rtcm/RtcmSsrDecoder.cpp`), and there is no SSR path that writes the slant-iono state $I^i_{r,1}$. Consequently the ionospheric term $\mu_s I^i_{r,1}$ of Equations (4) and (5) is informed only by (i) the per-satellite iono *state* estimated by the filter itself and (ii) the optional GIM/IONEX deterministic prior (`atmosphere/GlobalIonosphereMap`, an independent VTEC→STEC mapping unrelated to the SSR stream). Closing this gap — a regional STEC overlay feeding $I^i_{r,1}$ as a pseudo-observation, restoring the iono-weighted constraint that makes single-epoch AR feasible — is the natural extension of the network-side workstream and is not yet implemented.

10.6 Provenance and streaming code pointer

Both transports map onto the same internal correction structs (`rtcm/RtcmTypes.hpp`) through a single decoder (`rtcm/RtcmSsrDecoder.cpp`). Legacy RTCM uses per-constellation six-message blocks (orbit, clock, code bias, combined orbit+clock, URA, high-rate clock) plus a separate phase-bias block (1265–1270); IGS-SSR `4076` repackages the same payloads under a message-indicator IM = $10\,g$ + offset, with a uniform 6-bit satellite ID, 8-bit IODE, and 20-bit GPS-TOW epoch for all constellations (`RtcmSsrDecoder.cpp`). Note that the `4076` body ordering differs from the legacy ordering and that VTEC (IM 201) and NavIC (IM 141–147) are rejected by the message-indicator classifier *before* the header is parsed, so they return `ok = false` with an empty header.

The invariant correction definitions of Equations (88), (90) and (91) live in the static, deterministic `applyOrbitToPosition` / `applyClockToBias` / `iodeMatches` members of `products/SsrCorrectionStore`. The stateful streaming layer — the mutex-guarded per-satellite cache with wall-clock freshness gating, and the `RealTimeEngine::feedRtcmFrame` push loop (`realtime/RealTimeEngine.cpp`) that fans decoded vectors into the store — is kept separate so the correction math can be reasoned about (and tested) in isolation. The only user-facing SSR-related config is the warm-up gate `estimation.defer_until_corrections_ready` (`config/GnssConfigLoad.cpp`), which defers estimation until a solvable floor of satellites is broadcast-plus-SSR centimetre-grade, so the filter seeds code and phase together rather than cold-starting a contaminated partition on metre-grade broadcast clocks.

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